

ENGLISH FOR CLEANING TEAMS

Housekeeping and Commercial Cleaning English

Clear tasks. Reliable handovers.



Phil Stilwell

© 2026 Phil Stilwell. All rights reserved.

No part of this publication may be reproduced, stored in a retrieval system, or transmitted in any form or by any means without prior written permission from the author, except as permitted by law.

Eight scenarios. Eight extended conversations.

INSIDE THE BOOK

192 vocabulary entries / 128 reusable phrases

160 dialogue turns / 80 numbered dialogue gaps

Word banks and explained answer keys

Upper-intermediate to advanced (B2-C1). For room attendants, commercial cleaners, housekeeping teams, and cleaning supervisors.

2026 edition

Eight scenarios. Eight skills.

Eight workplace conversations: define an assignment, arrange an occupied-room visit, question an unreadable product label, report a floor hazard, transfer found property, count linen, respond to a quality concern, and hand over room statuses.

01 Confirming the assignment and its limits 4

What does everything include? | Restate a defined cleaning assignment, clarify an extra request, and preserve authorization despite a deadline.

02 Respecting access and occupied spaces 13

Not during the call | Acknowledge a declined visit, offer the actual return window, and distinguish an agreed plan from room-entry permission.

03 Clarifying product and task information 22

The unreadable label | Report uncertain product identity, request understandable information, and resist identification by color or familiarity.

04 Reporting faults and unsafe access 31

Outside washroom B | Give an exact location and observed condition, preserve uncertainty about the cause, and avoid premature clearance.

05 Handling found items and privacy questions 40

The closed black case | Describe found property without inspecting private contents, record its location, and confirm transfer to the designated receiver.

06 Counting linen and replenishing supplies 49

Three bath towels short | Report linen counts by item, calculate the exact shortfall, and separate expected delivery from stock on hand.

07 Responding to a quality concern 58

Streaks beside office 8 | Acknowledge a reported result, identify the exact surface, and arrange a check without inventing the cause or outcome.

08 Giving a clear end-of-shift handover 67

Three rooms, different stages | Report each room status separately, assign the unfinished steps, and avoid confusing cleaning with inspection or release.

Communication field notes	3
Answers and explanations	76
Fast-access phrase pages	92
Vocabulary index	94
Sources and publication notes	102

Name the place. Preserve the permission.

A useful cleaning message identifies the exact room or surface, what was observed or requested, and what may happen next. Clear English helps a worker be helpful without guessing a product, entering an unapproved space, or reporting unfinished work as complete.

Scope names the work

Everything is not a precise assignment. Repeat the listed surfaces and tasks, then send additional requests to the person who can authorize changes.

"My assignment covers table surfaces and the floor; I will check the extra request with my supervisor."

A time is not an entry permission

A return window helps coordinate service, but it does not replace actual access requirements. Keep a declined visit, an offered window, and permission to enter separate.

"I can return between eleven fifteen and eleven thirty; entry still follows our access procedure."

Visible details beat a guess

Report an unreadable label, the location of water, or the appearance of found property accurately. Do not guess chemical identity, fault cause, contents, or ownership.

"Water is visible outside washroom B, beside the east stair door; the source is unknown."

Done needs a named stage

Cleaned, inspected, accessible, and released are different states. Name the next owner and the unfinished step so a handover stays accurate.

"Room 302 is cleaned and awaits inspection; room 303 was not accessible and has not been cleaned."

PROFESSIONAL BOUNDARIES

All sites, rooms, quantities, guests, and incidents are fictional. This book teaches workplace English, not chemical handling, equipment operation, hazard control, legal advice, or specialist infection prevention. Follow actual training, product labels and safety data sheets, site access rules, privacy and found-property procedures, and emergency arrangements. No example authorizes unsafe access, use of an unidentified product, or release of an unchecked area.

What does everything include?

A Read the situation

Restate a defined cleaning assignment, clarify an extra request, and preserve authorization despite a deadline.

Cleaner Maya has a commercial assignment reading conference room: tables and floor. It covers table surfaces and the floor, not high windows or personal equipment. Client Jordan asks for everything before a 3:00 meeting and points to the high windows and laptops on the tables. Supervisor Rosa can clarify and authorize any additional work through the site process. No extra work has been approved, and the deadline does not expand permission. Maya must acknowledge the meeting, name the actual scope, and arrange clarification without promising all requested tasks.

PEOPLE / Jordan: Client contact | Maya: Cleaner

A BOUNDARY CAN INCLUDE A NEXT STEP

A direct request from a client may feel difficult to question. Acknowledge the practical need, state the assigned work plainly, and name who can clarify an addition. Helpful language does not require agreeing to work outside the actual authorization or training.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is Maya assigned to clean?

A Personal laptops only

C Table surfaces and the floor

B Anything requested before three

D Every object and high window

2. Who can clarify extra work?

A The deadline itself

C The assignment automatically expands

B Any passerby

D Supervisor Rosa

3. What does the 3:00 meeting establish?

A Completion of all tasks

C A stated time constraint, not expanded permission

B Authorization for high-window work

D Approval to clean personal devices

[Answers and explanations: page 76.](#)

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

assignment

Work specifically allocated to a worker or team.

IN USE confirm the assignment

scope of work

Defined tasks and boundaries of an assignment.

IN USE clarify the scope of work

task list

Written list of required work items.

IN USE review the task list

table surface

Exposed working area of a table.

IN USE clean the table surfaces

floor area

Specified section of floor within the assignment.

IN USE identify the floor area

high window

Window area requiring access above ordinary floor-level work.

IN USE clarify high-window work

personal equipment

Devices or items belonging to individual users.

IN USE exclude personal equipment

client contact

Person communicating requirements for the customer organization.

IN USE speak with the client contact

site supervisor

Person overseeing assigned work at the location.

IN USE consult the site supervisor

additional work

Work beyond the current assignment.

IN USE request additional work

authorization

Actual permission from the relevant responsible person or process.

IN USE obtain authorization

work order

Record describing requested or assigned work.

IN USE check the work order

Precision check

Before three identifies the requested deadline. It does not mean all tasks are authorized or feasible. Preserve the difference between the current assignment, an additional request, and an approved change.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

service specification

Description of the service and required outcome.

IN USE follow the service specification

exclusion

Item or task explicitly outside an assignment.

IN USE explain an exclusion

deadline

Time by which a task is requested or required.

IN USE clarify the deadline

meeting setup

Arrangement of a room for a meeting.

IN USE separate cleaning from meeting setup

surface access

Ability and permission to reach the relevant surface.

IN USE confirm surface access

approved change

Change accepted through the required process.

IN USE record an approved change

priority

Relative importance or order of assigned tasks.

IN USE confirm the priority

capacity

Available time, resources, and ability for the work.

IN USE check team capacity

completion estimate

Approximate expected finishing time.

IN USE obtain a completion estimate

task boundary

Limit of the work assigned or authorized.

IN USE state the task boundary

clarification request

Specific question sent to resolve uncertainty.

IN USE raise a clarification request

read-back

Repetition of the understood instruction for confirmation.

IN USE give a scope read-back

Precision check

Tables can mean table surfaces rather than every object resting on them. If access is blocked by personal equipment, ask for the actual site arrangement. Do not infer permission to handle devices or belongings from a general cleaning request.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE THE TIMING

"I understand the meeting starts at three."

CLARIFY EVERYTHING

"Which additional areas do you mean by everything?"

PROTECT PERSONAL EQUIPMENT

"Personal devices are outside the stated scope."

KEEP APPROVAL DISTINCT

"That request has not been approved yet."

READ THE ASSIGNMENT

"My task list says table surfaces and the floor."

NAME THE EXCLUSION

"High windows are not in my current assignment."

OFFER THE NEXT STEP

"I can ask Rosa to clarify the extra request."

AVOID A BLANKET PROMISE

"I cannot confirm all of that from this assignment."

Covers

Covers defines included work without implying every nearby task is included.

Outside the scope

This phrase states a task boundary, not a personal unwillingness to help.

Before versus by

Both can identify a deadline; neither supplies permission for extra work.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

CHECK THE BOUNDARY

"Does the work order include that surface?"

EXPLAIN THE DEADLINE

"The meeting time does not change the permission for the work."

ASK ABOUT ACCESS

"What is the approved arrangement for clearing the table surfaces?"

KEEP OWNERSHIP CLEAR

"Rosa can confirm whether additional work is authorized."

SUMMARIZE THE PRESENT SCOPE

"Table surfaces and floor remain the assigned tasks."

AVOID A GUESSED ESTIMATE

"I will not give a completion time I have not checked."

REPORT THE OUTCOME

"I will pass on the clarified instruction."

CLOSE THE READ-BACK

"I understand the request; I am checking the change before agreeing to it."

Request versus approval

A person can request more work before the authorized process accepts it.

Everything

Replace this broad word with specific surfaces and tasks.

Can ask

This commits to seeking clarification, not to receiving a particular answer.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which response is clearest?

- A** I will clean personal laptops because they are on a table.
- B** The deadline overrides the task list.
- C** My assignment covers the tables and floor; I will check the extra work with Rosa.
- D** Everything is automatically included.

2. Which statement wrongly treats urgency as permission?

- A** The meeting starts at three.
- B** Rosa can clarify extra work.
- C** The current task list covers the floor.
- D** The meeting is at three, so high windows are now authorized.

3. What should Maya avoid promising?

- A** A factual explanation of the exclusion
- B** Completion of every requested extra before three
- C** A clarification request to Rosa
- D** A read-back of the listed tasks

4. Why clarify tables?

- A** Objects on a table may be outside the assigned surface-cleaning scope.
- B** Tables always include all electronics everywhere.
- C** Personal equipment is never present.
- D** The floor automatically becomes excluded.

[Answers and explanations: page 76.](#)

What does everything include?

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

scope of work / site supervisor / deadline / approved change / surface access / clarification request / additional work / read-back / assignment / task list

- 01 **Jordan:** We have a meeting at three, so could you do everything in the conference room? The high windows and the laptops need attention too.
- 02 **Maya:** I understand the timing. My ¹ _____ covers the table surfaces and the floor. I need to clarify the extra areas before agreeing to include them.
- 03 **Jordan:** I thought everything in the room came under cleaning. The laptops are sitting on the tables, so would they not be part of that?
- 04 **Maya:** The ² _____ names the surfaces, not the personal equipment on them. I do not have permission from this task list to clean those devices.
- 05 **Jordan:** All right. But the high windows look noticeable from the meeting table. Could you add them because the meeting is important?
- 06 **Maya:** They would be ³ _____. I can ask Rosa about the request, but I cannot treat the meeting time as approval to take on that task.
- 07 **Jordan:** Who is Rosa in relation to this job? I would like the request to reach someone who can give us a clear answer.
- 08 **Maya:** Rosa is the ⁴ _____. She can clarify the authorized work and the arrangements needed for anything beyond my present assignment.
- 09 **Jordan:** Please ask her, then. I do not want you to tell me yes now and later discover the work could not actually be done.
- 10 **Maya:** I will raise a ⁵ _____ identifying the high windows and personal equipment. I will also mention the three o'clock meeting as the time constraint.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 10.

- 11 **Jordan:** That would help. Meanwhile, what can I tell the meeting organizer is currently included, without promising the extras on your behalf?
- 12 **Maya:** You can say the ⁶ _____ covers table surfaces and floor. The extra request is being checked; no change has been approved yet.
- 13 **Jordan:** And if the laptops are in the way of the table surfaces, should I simply assume you will move them aside?
- 14 **Maya:** Please do not assume that. We need the approved ⁷ _____ arrangement for those areas. Cleaning the table does not automatically authorize me to handle personal equipment.
- 15 **Jordan:** Understood. I can wait for the clarification on that. The main thing is to avoid different people giving different instructions at once.
- 16 **Maya:** Yes. Any ⁸ _____ needs to be clear in the work instructions. That helps the team know what is included and what remains outside the task.
- 17 **Jordan:** You have not promised that all the extras will be finished by three, have you? I want to repeat your position accurately.
- 18 **Maya:** Correct. The ⁹ _____ is noted, but I have not confirmed extra work or a completion estimate for it. Rosa needs to clarify those points.
- 19 **Jordan:** Thank you. Please pass on the two extra requests and the meeting time. I will describe the current work as tables and floor only.
- 20 **Maya:** That is an accurate ¹⁰ _____. I will take the clarification to Rosa and communicate the actual outcome, without treating the request itself as permission to proceed.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 77

1. assignment | 2. scope of work | 3. additional work | 4. site supervisor | 5. clarification request | 6. task list | 7. surface access | 8. approved change | 9. deadline | 10. read-back

Clarify a different commercial assignment

F Say it

A work order covers reception counters and the lobby floor. The client adds exterior signs before noon. Supervisor Leon can review changes, but no extra work is approved.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

approved / counters / Leon / signs

Cleaner: "The assigned horizontal surfaces are the reception ¹ _____."

Client: "The additional request concerns the exterior ² _____."

Cleaner: "I will ask ³ _____ to review the request."

Cleaner: "The extra work is not yet ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 77

1. counters | 2. signs | 3. Leon | 4. approved

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Not during the call

A Read the situation

Acknowledge a declined visit, offer the actual return window, and distinguish an agreed plan from room-entry permission.

At 10:00, guest Alex in room 312 declines cleaning because a call is expected to last until 11:00. Attendant Lina can return between 11:15 and 11:30 or offer fresh towels at the door now. Alex chooses the return window and does not request towels at the door. Lina must record that plan accurately without promising exactly 11:00 or treating the end of the call as permission to enter. Actual room-access procedures still apply when the attendant returns. No room entry or cleaning completion occurs in this conversation.

PEOPLE / Alex: Guest in room 312 | Lina: Room attendant

GIVE CONTROL WITHOUT INVENTING AVAILABILITY

A guest may need privacy without wanting to cancel service entirely. Offer the real options in plain language and repeat the chosen window. Respecting the current refusal is compatible with arranging a later visit; neither requires assuming future entry permission.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Why is cleaning declined at 10:00?

- | | |
|---|---|
| A The guest is on a call until about 11:00 | B The room has already been released |
| C The attendant has no assigned room | D The guest cancels every future visit |

2. What return window is available?

- | | |
|------------------------------------|----------------------|
| A Any time without checking | B 11:15-11:30 |
| C Exactly 11:00 | D 10:00-10:15 |

3. What does Alex choose?

- | | |
|--|---------------------------------------|
| A An exact eleven o'clock appointment | B Cancellation of all cleaning |
| C The return window, without towels now | D Entry during the call |

Answers and explanations: page 78.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

occupied room

Room currently in use by a guest or other occupant.

IN USE respect an occupied room

room attendant

Worker assigned to guest-room cleaning and related service.

IN USE speak with the room attendant

declined service

Offered service the occupant does not accept at that time.

IN USE record declined service

return window

Time range in which a worker can come back.

IN USE offer a return window

appointment time

Specific agreed time rather than a broad window.

IN USE confirm the appointment time

privacy

Freedom from inappropriate intrusion or disclosure.

IN USE respect guest privacy

access permission

Authorization to enter or use a particular space.

IN USE confirm access permission

entry procedure

Actual required steps and rules for entering a space.

IN USE follow the entry procedure

doorstep delivery

Handover of an item at the doorway rather than room entry.

IN USE offer doorstep delivery

fresh towels

Clean towels available for guest use.

IN USE offer fresh towels

service option

Available choice about the service to be provided.

IN USE explain a service option

do-not-disturb notice

Guest instruction or signal requesting no interruption under site rules.

IN USE respect a do-not-disturb notice

Precision check

Until eleven describes the guest call. Between eleven fifteen and eleven thirty describes the available return window. Neither means the attendant has promised to arrive exactly when the call ends.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

service request

Guest's stated request for an available service.

IN USE record a service request

visit plan

Arrangement for a future visit.

IN USE confirm the visit plan

availability

Time or circumstances in which a person or service can be accessed.

IN USE clarify availability

time range

Interval with a beginning and end.

IN USE repeat the time range

scheduled return

Planned later visit within the agreed arrangement.

IN USE record a scheduled return

unoccupied

Not currently occupied, where that status is actually established.

IN USE verify unoccupied status

guest preference

Stated service choice or wish of the guest.

IN USE record the guest preference

access record

Record of relevant entry or permission information.

IN USE update the access record

interruption

Action that disturbs an ongoing activity.

IN USE avoid an unnecessary interruption

service deferral

Moving a service to a later available opportunity.

IN USE arrange a service deferral

exact-time promise

Commitment to a specific arrival time.

IN USE avoid an unsupported exact-time promise

confirmation

Clear agreement about the understood plan.

IN USE obtain confirmation

Precision check

A later visit plan does not replace actual access rules. Do not equate silence, an expected end time, or a prior conversation with permission to enter. Keep room status, guest preference, and entry authorization distinct.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE THE REFUSAL

"Certainly; I will not start service now."

OFFER THE REAL WINDOW

"I can return between eleven fifteen and eleven thirty."

OFFER THE SEPARATE OPTION

"I can offer fresh towels at the door now."

ASK FOR THE CHOICE

"Which of those options would suit you?"

CLARIFY THE TIMING

"Your call is expected to finish at eleven."

AVOID AN EXACT PROMISE

"I cannot promise exactly eleven."

KEEP ENTRY SEPARATE

"A towel handover does not require us to assume room entry."

CONFIRM THE RETURN

"I have recorded the eleven-fifteen-to-eleven-thirty window."

Between and

Use both endpoints to communicate a real time window.

Until

Until eleven identifies the call's expected duration, not an entry authorization.

Now versus later

Declining now does not necessarily reject all future service.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

PRESERVE THE REFUSAL

"Cleaning was declined at ten because of your call."

RESPECT PRIVACY

"I understand that you do not want an interruption."

KEEP TOWELS DISTINCT

"No towel delivery is requested now."

CHECK AGREEMENT

"Have I understood your preference correctly?"

AVOID OVERGENERALIZING

"You are postponing this visit, not cancelling every service."

EXPLAIN THE LATER CHECK

"We will still follow the entry procedure when we return."

REPEAT THE ROOM

"This plan is for room 312."

CLOSE POLITELY

"Thank you; I will record the agreed return plan."

Can return

State an available option without silently converting it to an exact appointment.

At the door

This specifies a limited handover location, not access to the whole room.

Expected

An expected end time remains different from a completed event.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which read-back is accurate?

- A** Return between 11:15 and 11:30; no towels requested now.
- B** Enter exactly at 11:00.
- C** Cleaning is permanently cancelled.
- D** Deliver towels and start cleaning during the call.

2. What does the call ending at eleven establish?

- A** Completed cleaning
- B** A new room number
- C** Expected availability information, not automatic entry permission
- D** A universal right to enter at eleven

3. Which offer is within Lina's stated options?

- A** Immediate entry despite refusal
- B** An unpromised late-night visit
- C** Fresh towels at the door now
- D** Guaranteed arrival at 11:00

4. Why record the exact window?

- A** To make permission unnecessary
- B** To prove the room is empty
- C** To claim the service is complete
- D** To avoid turning a time range into a different appointment

Answers and explanations: page 78.

Not during the call

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

entry procedure / declined service / confirmation / guest preference / service deferral / visit plan / time range / availability / fresh towels / return window

- 01 **Alex:** I cannot have the room cleaned now. I have a call that is expected to run until eleven, and I need some privacy.
- 02 **Lina:** Of course. I will record this as ¹ _____ for now because of your call. We can discuss a later option without starting anything in the room.
- 03 **Alex:** Thank you. Could you come back as soon as the call ends? Eleven would be convenient if you have that time available.
- 04 **Lina:** My available ² _____ is between eleven fifteen and eleven thirty. I cannot promise exactly eleven, but I can offer that later range.
- 05 **Alex:** That should work. I want to hear the other option too, in case I decide I only need towels today.
- 06 **Lina:** I can offer ³ _____ at the door now. That is separate from the later room-cleaning visit, so you can choose the option you prefer.
- 07 **Alex:** I think I would rather have the cleaning visit later. I do not need the towels brought to the door now as well.
- 08 **Lina:** Understood. Your ⁴ _____ is a return between eleven fifteen and eleven thirty, without a towel delivery now. I will record those details together.
- 09 **Alex:** Please do. I have had situations where a time range became an exact time when the message reached another member of staff.
- 10 **Lina:** I will keep it as a ⁵ _____, not an exact appointment. The earliest point offered is eleven fifteen, and the end of the window is eleven thirty.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 19.

- 11 **Alex:** And if the call is still going when someone comes back, I do not want them to assume they can enter because we spoke earlier.
- 12 **Lina:** We will still follow the ⁶ _____ when we return. This conversation records a visit plan; it does not replace the required access arrangements.
- 13 **Alex:** Good. The call should finish at eleven, but that is an expectation, not something I can guarantee before it happens.
- 14 **Lina:** I understand. Your expected ⁷ _____ helps us plan, but we will not treat the clock reaching eleven as automatic permission to enter the room.
- 15 **Alex:** Thank you for making that distinction. I am not cancelling all cleaning, just asking not to be interrupted during this call.
- 16 **Lina:** I will describe it as a ⁸ _____. You have selected the later window rather than refusing every future visit or requesting immediate cleaning.
- 17 **Alex:** Could you repeat the room number too? I want to make sure this gets attached to the correct room on your list.
- 18 **Lina:** Room three hundred twelve. The ⁹ _____ is a return between eleven fifteen and eleven thirty, with no fresh-towel delivery requested now.
- 19 **Alex:** Yes, that is right. I appreciate the clear options. I will continue my call and expect the later visit within that window.
- 20 **Lina:** Thank you for the ¹⁰ _____. I will record it accurately and respect your privacy now. The later visit will still follow the normal access requirements.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 79

1. declined service | 2. return window | 3. fresh towels | 4. guest preference | 5. time range | 6. entry procedure | 7. availability | 8. service deferral | 9. visit plan | 10. confirmation

Record another return window

F Say it

At 9:00, room 420 declines service during a call until 10:00. The offered return window is 10:30-10:45. The guest chooses that window and does not request towels now.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

10:30-10:45 / 10:00 / 420 / access procedure

Attendant: "This plan is for room ¹ _____."

Guest: "The call is expected to finish at ² _____."

Attendant: "The return window is ³ _____."

Attendant: "Entry still follows the actual ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 79

1. 420 | 2. 10:00 | 3. 10:30-10:45 | 4. access procedure

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

The unreadable label

A Read the situation

03

Report uncertain product identity, request understandable information, and resist identification by color or familiarity.

Cleaner Farah notices an unreadable label on a bottle on the cleaning cart. Colleague Owen believes it is the usual surface cleaner because of its color, but two products use similar bottles. Farah has not used it. Supervisor Ben can identify the product through the actual site process and provide the relevant information or a clearly identified replacement. No identity, mixing instruction, dilution ratio, protective-equipment selection, or use approval is established here. The task is to ask precise questions and preserve the stopped-use status while the uncertainty is resolved.

PEOPLE / Farah: Cleaner | Owen: Colleague

QUESTION THE EVIDENCE, NOT THE COLLEAGUE

A familiar coworker may offer a confident shortcut in good faith. Explain the specific uncertainty, such as two similar bottles, and request a reliable identification. This keeps the discussion cooperative while making clear that confidence or seniority cannot replace the missing product information.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is wrong with the bottle?

- A** Its label is unreadable
- C** It has already been used by Farah

- B** Its identity is fully verified
- D** Its instructions are clear

2. Why is color insufficient here?

- A** No product information is needed
- C** Color always identifies every product

- B** Two products use similar bottles
- D** Owen has supplied a readable product code

3. What can Ben arrange?

- A** A smell test taught by this book
- C** An invented dilution ratio

- B** Proper identification and information, or an identified replacement
- D** Approval based only on memory

Answers and explanations: [page 80](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

product identifier

Name or code used to identify a specific chemical product.

IN USE verify the product identifier

unreadable label

Label whose information cannot be reliably read.

IN USE report an unreadable label

container

Vessel holding a substance or product.

IN USE identify the container

secondary container

Container into which a product has been transferred from another container.

IN USE check a secondary container

safety data sheet

Document describing a chemical product's hazards and relevant safety information.

IN USE consult the safety data sheet

SDS

Abbreviation for safety data sheet.

IN USE obtain the relevant SDS

hazard statement

Standardized wording describing the nature of a chemical hazard.

IN USE read the hazard statement

precautionary statement

Wording describing measures to prevent or reduce harmful effects.

IN USE understand the precautionary statement

signal word

Label word indicating the relative severity of a hazard.

IN USE identify the signal word

pictogram

Graphic symbol communicating a hazard or other defined information.

IN USE recognize the pictogram

product information

Relevant identifying, hazard, and use information for a product.

IN USE request product information

manufacturer instructions

Directions supplied by the product or equipment manufacturer.

IN USE follow manufacturer instructions

Precision check

A product identifier must connect the actual container with the relevant information. A similar bottle or familiar color does not establish identity. Do not infer use instructions, surface suitability, or protection requirements from an unverified guess.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

surface compatibility

Whether a product is suitable for a particular surface material.

IN USE verify surface compatibility

cleaner

Product intended to remove soil or unwanted material from a surface.

IN USE identify the cleaner

detergent

Cleaning agent that helps remove soil.

IN USE identify the detergent

disinfectant

Product intended to kill or inactivate specified microorganisms when used as directed.

IN USE identify the disinfectant

sanitizer

Product used to reduce microorganisms to an applicable specified level.

IN USE distinguish a sanitizer

dilution

Reduction in concentration according to the applicable instructions.

IN USE verify dilution instructions

concentrate

Product supplied at a strength requiring the specified preparation before use.

IN USE identify a concentrate

ready-to-use

Supplied in a form intended for use without additional dilution, as directed.

IN USE confirm ready-to-use status

PPE

Personal protective equipment selected for the actual hazards and task.

IN USE verify required PPE

ventilation

Supply or movement of air relevant to working conditions.

IN USE check ventilation requirements

exposure

Contact with a substance through a relevant route.

IN USE report an exposure

identified replacement

Substitute product with its identity and relevant information established.

IN USE request an identified replacement

Precision check

Cleaning, sanitizing, and disinfecting are different functions. The required product and process depend on the actual task and site. This vocabulary does not authorize a chemical procedure or replace understandable training and current product instructions.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

03

STATE THE PROBLEM

"I cannot read this bottle label."

QUESTION THE IDENTIFICATION

"What reliable information identifies this container?"

REJECT A COLOR-ONLY GUESS

"The color does not establish which product this is."

REQUEST INFORMATION

"I need the relevant product information in a form I can understand."

PRESERVE THE STATUS

"I have not used the product."

EXPLAIN THE AMBIGUITY

"Two products use similar bottles here."

ASK FOR THE SUPERVISOR

"Can Ben verify the identity through the site process?"

ASK FOR THE DOCUMENT

"Which safety data sheet belongs to this product?"

Looks like

This reports resemblance, not verified identity.

The relevant

The relevant SDS must match the actual product rather than a similar bottle.

Have not used

This clearly states the current status without implying exposure.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

03

CHECK THE MATCH

"The information must match the actual container."

AVOID A GUESSED RATIO

"I will not invent dilution instructions."

KEEP THE PAUSE VISIBLE

"The product remains unused while identity is unresolved."

AVOID A FALSE APPROVAL

"We have not confirmed this product for the task."

REQUEST A REPLACEMENT

"A clearly identified replacement may resolve the immediate problem."

SEPARATE COMPATIBILITY

"We also need the product to suit the assigned surface."

ASK FOR CLARIFICATION

"Please explain that instruction before I proceed."

CLOSE THE REQUEST

"Let us get verified identification and the relevant instructions."

Before proceeding

This establishes the sequence of clarification before action.

Understandable

Receiving a document is not the same as understanding the instruction.

Replacement

A replacement needs clear identification; another unknown bottle does not solve the problem.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which response challenges the shortcut constructively?

- A** I will test it by mixing it with another cleaner.
- B** Two products look similar; let us ask Ben to verify this one.
- C** You are careless and always wrong.
- D** The color proves it is safe.

2. Which document is relevant?

- A** A cafe recipe
- B** The safety data sheet matching the actual product
- C** Any sheet with a similar logo
- D** An old memory of another product

3. Which statement is unsupported?

- A** Ben can arrange identification.
- B** This product is approved for the surface because the bottle looks familiar.
- C** The label is unreadable.
- D** Farah has not used it.

4. What should remain clear in the handoff?

- A** Product used successfully
- B** Dilution ratio invented
- C** Every similar bottle is interchangeable
- D** Identity unresolved and product unused

Answers and explanations: [page 80](#).

The unreadable label

E Conversations / turns 1-10

03

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

clarification / identified replacement / product identifier / Surface compatibility / safety data sheet / unused / unreadable label / looks like / dilution / product information

- 01 **Farah:** I cannot read the label on this bottle. Before I do anything with it, I need to know what product it actually contains.
- 02 **Owen:** It ¹ _____ the surface cleaner we usually use. The color is familiar, although I have not checked a readable name or code on this one.
- 03 **Farah:** There are two products in similar bottles here, so the color does not settle it. I have not used this bottle on any surface.
- 04 **Owen:** You are right to separate appearance from the ² _____. I cannot give you a verified identity just from recognizing the general bottle style.
- 05 **Farah:** Can Ben help identify it? I would like to give him a precise question instead of asking whether the bottle is probably all right.
- 06 **Owen:** Yes. We can report the ³ _____ and say the product remains unused. He can arrange identification through the actual site process.
- 07 **Farah:** If he identifies it, I also need the relevant instructions. Knowing a name would not tell me every requirement for this particular surface.
- 08 **Owen:** We should request the matching ⁴ _____, including the appropriate label and safety information. We should not fill in missing directions from memory.
- 09 **Farah:** I have heard people say SDS. I want to make sure I ask for the correct document rather than just another sheet with a similar name.
- 10 **Owen:** SDS means ⁵ _____. The important point is that it must match the actual product, not merely another container that looks similar.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

03

Continue with the word bank on page 28.

- 11 **Farah:** Thank you. And if the bottle cannot be identified promptly, could we ask for a different one with clear information instead?
- 12 **Owen:** Ben can arrange an ⁶ _____ through the site process. That means a product with clear identification and relevant instructions, not another unknown bottle.
- 13 **Farah:** I do not want someone to hear that request as permission to choose any cleaner from the cart and use it in the same way.
- 14 **Owen:** Agreed. ⁷ _____ still matters. We need the appropriate product for the assigned task, with the actual instructions and training requirements followed.
- 15 **Farah:** I also will not guess a mixing amount or a dilution from a previous job. The products and arrangements may be different here.
- 16 **Owen:** Correct. Any ⁸ _____ instruction must come from the applicable information. This conversation has not established a ratio or authorized any preparation step.
- 17 **Farah:** Please include that I have not used it. I want Ben to know this is an identification query, not a report that I already tried it.
- 18 **Owen:** I will preserve that ⁹ _____ status in the message. We should also keep any exposure or incident report factual if something different ever occurs.
- 19 **Farah:** Good. Once the information is available, I will ask about any part I do not understand before I proceed with the assigned task.
- 20 **Owen:** That is the point of ¹⁰ _____. Let us ask Ben for reliable identification and understandable instructions, keeping the product unused while this uncertainty remains.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 81

1. looks like | 2. product identifier | 3. unreadable label | 4. product information | 5. safety data sheet | 6. identified replacement | 7. Surface compatibility | 8. dilution | 9. unused | 10. clarification

Report another unidentified container

F Say it

A spray bottle on cart C has an unreadable label. Worker Ana has not used it. Lead Leon can arrange identification or an identified replacement. Product color is not sufficient evidence.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

unreadable / unused / Leon / C

Worker: "The affected bottle is on cart ¹ _____."

Worker: "The label is ² _____."

Colleague: "The lead for this query is ³ _____."

Worker: "The product remains ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 81

1. C | 2. unreadable | 3. Leon | 4. unused

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Outside washroom B

A Read the situation

04

Give an exact location and observed condition, preserve uncertainty about the cause, and avoid premature clearance.

Cleaner Ravi sees water on the floor outside washroom B, beside the east stair door. Ravi does not know its source and has already reported it under the site safety arrangements. Supervisor Elena asks for a clear follow-up message identifying the location and current status. The affected area has not been declared ready. No leak diagnosis, repair result, completed cleanup, or approved reopening is established. The exchange practices accurate reporting while the actual site controls remain in effect; it does not teach a cleanup method or authorize anyone to enter the affected area.

PEOPLE / Ravi: Cleaner | Elena: Supervisor

URGENCY NEEDS PRECISION

A brief hazard message can be both direct and respectful. Lead with the location and observed condition, then state what is unknown and who has been informed. Do not soften a hazard into nothing serious or strengthen a location clue into an unsupported diagnosis.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Where is the water?

A Inside washroom A

C In an unidentified guest room

B On the west stair landing

D Outside washroom B, beside the east stair door

2. What does Ravi know about the source?

A It is unknown

C A guest deliberately spilled it

B A pipe has definitely burst

D The roof was repaired

3. What is the readiness status?

A It is safe because a report exists

C It is approved for reopening

B The affected area has not been declared ready

D Cleanup and inspection are complete

Answers and explanations: page 82.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

observed condition

What the worker directly notices at the location.

IN USE report the observed condition

exact location

Specific place described with enough detail to identify it.

IN USE give the exact location

landmark

Recognizable feature used to locate another place.

IN USE name a clear landmark

washroom

Room containing toilet and washing facilities.

IN USE identify the washroom

stair door

Door providing access to a stairway.

IN USE identify the stair door

corridor

Passage connecting rooms or areas.

IN USE locate the corridor

threshold

Floor-level boundary at a doorway.

IN USE identify the threshold

stair landing

Level platform between flights or at a stair entrance.

IN USE describe the stair landing

visible water

Water that can be directly seen.

IN USE report visible water

source

Origin of the observed condition.

IN USE investigate the source

leak

Unintended escape of liquid from a system or container.

IN USE verify a suspected leak

slip hazard

Condition that may cause a person to slip.

IN USE report a slip hazard

Precision check

Outside washroom B and beside the east stair door locate the water. They do not establish that it came from the washroom or stairs. Keep the observed location separate from the unknown source.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

trip hazard

Obstacle or condition that may cause a person to trip.

IN USE distinguish a trip hazard

affected area

Specific area involved in an incident or condition.

IN USE identify the affected area

site controls

Actual measures governing safety and access at a location.

IN USE follow site controls

hazard report

Message recording a potentially harmful condition.

IN USE submit a hazard report

maintenance referral

Transfer of a fault concern to the relevant maintenance team.

IN USE arrange a maintenance referral

fault diagnosis

Determination of the cause or nature of a defect.

IN USE avoid an unsupported fault diagnosis

status update

Report of the current state of the matter.

IN USE provide a status update

clearance

Required authorization that an area or item may return to the specified use.

IN USE await clearance

reopening

Making an area available again after the relevant controls and approval.

IN USE confirm reopening

readiness

State of being prepared and authorized for the specified next use.

IN USE verify readiness

report acknowledgement

Confirmation that the hazard message was received.

IN USE obtain report acknowledgement

follow-up owner

Person responsible for the next check or update.

IN USE name the follow-up owner

Precision check

Reported, assessed, cleaned, repaired, and cleared describe different stages. A received report cannot serve as reopening approval. Actual hazard controls and emergency arrangements take precedence over this language exercise.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

LEAD WITH LOCATION

"Water is visible outside washroom B."

STATE UNCERTAINTY

"I do not know the source."

CONFIRM REPORTING

"I have reported it under the site arrangements."

ASK FOR ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

"Please confirm you have the correct location."

ADD THE LANDMARK

"It is beside the east stair door."

AVOID A DIAGNOSIS

"I am not confirming a plumbing fault."

PRESERVE THE STATUS

"The area has not been declared ready."

CORRECT DIRECTION

"East stair door, not west."

Outside versus inside

This contrast can direct a responder to the correct side of a doorway.

Beside

A landmark locates a condition without identifying its cause.

Visible

This describes direct observation, not a diagnosis or measurement.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

KEEP OBSERVATIONS FACTUAL

"I am reporting what I can see."

KEEP CONTROLS ACTIVE

"The actual site controls still apply."

SEPARATE REPORT AND ACTION

"Receipt of the report does not mean the work is complete."

GIVE A BOUNDED UPDATE

"The location is confirmed; the source remains unknown."

AVOID MINIMIZING

"I cannot describe it as harmless."

REQUEST THE NEXT OWNER

"Who is taking the follow-up?"

AVOID REOPENING LANGUAGE

"I have no clearance to report."

CLOSE THE MESSAGE

"Please keep the current status attached to that location."

Has not been declared

The phrase preserves the absence of authorized readiness.

Still

Use still to carry an unresolved status into the next message.

East versus west

Repeat direction explicitly when a similar landmark exists elsewhere.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which message is most precise?

- A** It is nothing serious.
- B** Water outside washroom B, beside the east stair door; source unknown.
- C** Water somewhere near the toilets.
- D** The east stair plumbing has definitely failed.

2. Which inference is not supported?

- A** Water is visible on the floor.
- B** The east stair door is a landmark.
- C** The area is not declared ready.
- D** The water definitely comes from a broken pipe.

3. What does report acknowledgement mean?

- A** Reopening is approved
- B** The source is repaired
- C** The message was received, not that the area is cleared
- D** Cleanup is complete

4. What should a follow-up preserve?

- A** An invented cause to sound decisive
- B** An all-clear because the supervisor answered
- C** A promised repair time without checking
- D** Location, observed condition, unknown source, and current readiness status

Answers and explanations: [page 82](#).

Outside washroom B

E Conversations / turns 1-10

04

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

observed condition / east stair door / source / clearance / hazard report / report acknowledgement / affected area / fault diagnosis / outside washroom B / status update

- 01 **Elena:** I have your report about water near the washrooms. Before I pass it on, please give me the exact location and current status.
- 02 **Ravi:** It is ¹ _____, beside the east stair door. Water is visible on the floor there; I do not know where it came from.
- 03 **Elena:** Thank you. I want to be certain I heard the direction correctly. Is that the east stair door rather than the west one?
- 04 **Ravi:** Yes, the ² _____. I am using it as the landmark for the location, not claiming that the water came from the stairway.
- 05 **Elena:** That distinction matters. Has anyone established a source, or is the message still limited to what you observed on the floor?
- 06 **Ravi:** The ³ _____ remains unknown to me. I have not diagnosed a pipe, a drain, or any other cause from the location alone.
- 07 **Elena:** Have you already reported the condition through the site arrangements? I do not want this follow-up conversation to replace the required safety response.
- 08 **Ravi:** Yes, I have made the ⁴ _____ under those arrangements. The actual site controls still apply while the condition is being addressed.
- 09 **Elena:** Good. Please also state whether the affected area has been declared ready. I need to avoid passing on an accidental all-clear.
- 10 **Ravi:** There is no ⁵ _____ for me to report. The area has not been declared ready, and my report should not be read as approval to use it.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

04

Continue with the word bank on page 37.

- 11 **Elena:** Understood. I will keep that status in the message. Could you summarize the observation without adding a probable cause?
- 12 **Ravi:** The ⁶ _____ is water on the floor outside washroom B, beside the east stair door. That is what I can state directly.
- 13 **Elena:** Some people may hear near the washroom and assume a plumbing leak. I will make clear that the source still needs appropriate assessment.
- 14 **Ravi:** Thank you. A ⁷ _____ has not been made by me. The location helps someone find the condition, but it does not prove what caused it.
- 15 **Elena:** I have the details now. Receiving them is one stage; it does not mean cleanup, repair, or any required inspection has finished.
- 16 **Ravi:** Exactly. Your ⁸ _____ tells me the message arrived. It should not be turned into a completed-work entry or a statement that the area is ready.
- 17 **Elena:** I will coordinate the follow-up through the site process and keep the responsible people informed. No reopening decision is being made in this exchange.
- 18 **Ravi:** Then I will keep the ⁹ _____ factual: location confirmed, source unknown, area not declared ready. I will report any new observation through the same arrangements.
- 19 **Elena:** That is clear. Please retain the exact wording of the location when the next worker takes over, especially outside and east.
- 20 **Ravi:** I will. The ¹⁰ _____ remains outside washroom B beside the east stair door. I will not replace that precise report with a guessed cause or an all-clear.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 83

1. outside washroom B | 2. east stair door | 3. source | 4. hazard report | 5. clearance | 6. observed condition | 7. fault diagnosis | 8. report acknowledgement | 9. status update | 10. affected area

Report a different wet-floor location

F Say it

Water is visible outside washroom D beside the west service door. The source is unknown. A report has been made, but the area has not been declared ready.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

unknown / D / ready / west

Cleaner: "The water is outside washroom ¹ _____."

Supervisor: "The landmark is the ² _____ service door."

Cleaner: "The source remains ³ _____."

Supervisor: "The area is not declared ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 83

1. D | 2. west | 3. unknown | 4. ready

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

The closed black case

A Read the situation

Describe found property without inspecting private contents, record its location, and confirm transfer to the designated receiver.

05

After checkout, attendant Ana finds a closed black glasses case beneath the chair in room 214. The owner is unknown, and Ana does not open the case. Dev is the designated lost-property receiver and can accept it through the site procedure. The handover should record only established details and confirm receipt. A room number does not by itself identify the owner, and the appearance of a glasses case does not confirm what is inside. Any later ownership claim or release requires the actual verification process, not a guess during this conversation.

PEOPLE / Ana: Room attendant | Dev: Designated lost-property receiver

CAREFUL DESCRIPTION PROTECTS EVERYONE

A found item can prompt curiosity or pressure to identify its owner quickly. Keep the report neutral and limited to the visible details needed for the task. A confirmed transfer is useful progress without inventing ownership or discussing a guest with someone who has no verified role.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Where was the case found?

A Beneath a chair in room 241

B At an unidentified reception desk

C Beneath the chair in room 214

D Inside the wardrobe in room 214

2. What is known about the owner?

A The owner is unknown

B The last registered guest definitely owns it

C Dev owns it

D Ana has verified a claimant

3. Who is the designated receiver?

A The next guest automatically

B Dev

C Any caller who describes a black case

D An unnamed visitor

Answers and explanations: page 84.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

found property

Item discovered whose owner or custody needs appropriate handling.

IN USE report found property

lost-property receiver

Designated person who accepts found items under the site process.

IN USE contact the lost-property receiver

visible description

Account limited to details observable without inspecting hidden contents.

IN USE give a visible description

glasses case

Container designed for spectacles, regardless of its actual contents.

IN USE describe the glasses case

closed item

Item whose interior is not exposed or inspected.

IN USE preserve the closed item

contents

Items or material inside a container.

IN USE avoid guessing the contents

owner

Person with ownership of an item, requiring appropriate verification.

IN USE verify the owner

claimant

Person stating that an item belongs to them.

IN USE refer a claimant for verification

ownership claim

Statement that a person owns the item.

IN USE verify an ownership claim

find location

Place where an item was discovered.

IN USE record the find location

checkout

End-of-stay departure process for a guest.

IN USE distinguish checkout from ownership

property record

Entry documenting a found item and relevant handling details.

IN USE create a property record

Precision check

Found after checkout is a timing fact, not proof that the last guest owns the item. Record the room and location accurately while leaving ownership unknown until the actual process verifies it.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

item description

Identifying account of the item itself.

IN USE record the item description

transfer

Passing an item to the designated next holder.

IN USE document the transfer

receipt confirmation

Acknowledgement that the intended receiver has obtained the item.

IN USE obtain receipt confirmation

custody

Responsibility for holding an item at a given stage.

IN USE confirm custody

custody record

Record of who held or received an item through the process.

IN USE maintain the custody record

reference number

Identifier attached to a record or case.

IN USE record the reference number

privacy boundary

Limit on access to or disclosure of personal information.

IN USE respect the privacy boundary

disclosure

Sharing of information with another person.

IN USE avoid unauthorized disclosure

verified recipient

Person whose entitlement to receive the item has been established.

IN USE identify the verified recipient

release

Authorized handover to the person entitled to receive the item.

IN USE authorize release

site procedure

Required local process for handling the matter.

IN USE follow the site procedure

factual correction

Amendment that replaces an inaccurate detail with the verified fact.

IN USE make a factual correction

Precision check

Glasses case describes the visible container. It does not prove glasses are inside. Keep the item closed in this scenario and transfer it to the designated receiver without turning a description into a search of private contents.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

OPEN THE REPORT

"I found a closed black glasses case."

GIVE THE POSITION

"It was beneath the chair."

PRESERVE UNCERTAINTY

"I do not know the owner."

IDENTIFY THE RECEIVER

"Are you the designated lost-property receiver?"

GIVE THE ROOM

"It was in room 214."

STATE TIMING

"I found it after checkout."

AVOID A CONTENTS CLAIM

"I have not opened it, so I cannot describe what is inside."

REQUEST TRANSFER

"I need to hand this over through the site procedure."

Found versus owned

Finding an item in a room does not prove who owns it.

Beneath

This gives a specific position rather than a vague room-level description.

Closed

Include this visible condition without asserting what the item contains.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

ASK FOR RECEIPT

"Please confirm when you have received the item."

SEPARATE CUSTODY AND OWNERSHIP

"Receiving it does not identify its owner."

ROUTE A CLAIM

"Ownership claims need the actual verification process."

CORRECT A NUMBER

"The room is 214, not 241."

REPEAT THE DESCRIPTION

"Closed black glasses case, beneath the chair, room 214."

PROTECT PRIVACY

"I cannot share guest details with an unverified caller."

AVOID RELEASE BY GUESS

"A room number alone is not release authorization."

CLOSE THE HANDOVER

"The transfer is recorded; ownership remains unverified."

Received versus released

Staff receipt and return to a verified owner are different handovers.

Unknown

Use unknown where no ownership evidence has been established.

After checkout

This describes when the discovery occurred, not who left the item.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which description is supported?

- A** Prescription glasses belonging to the last guest
- B** An empty case confirmed by opening it
- C** A valuable item with a known owner
- D** Closed black glasses case beneath the chair in room 214

2. What does Dev's receipt establish?

- A** Completed return to the owner
- B** Transfer to the designated receiver
- C** Verified ownership by a guest
- D** Authorization for public disclosure

3. Which statement exceeds the evidence?

- A** The owner is unknown.
- B** It must belong to the last person who stayed in the room.
- C** It was found after checkout.
- D** The case is black and closed.

4. What should happen to a later claim?

- A** Open the case out of curiosity
- B** Follow the actual ownership-verification and release process
- C** Release immediately based only on room number
- D** Share all guest information with the caller

Answers and explanations: [page 84](#).

The closed black case

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

05

WORD + PHRASE BANK

custody record / visible description / ownership / receipt confirmation / privacy boundary / ownership claim / property record / find location / release / lost-property receiver

- 01 **Ana:** I have found an item after checkout in room two hundred fourteen. I need to pass it to the designated lost-property receiver.
- 02 **Dev:** I am the ¹ _____ for this handover. Please give me the visible description and exact find location before we record the transfer.
- 03 **Ana:** It is a closed black glasses case. I found it beneath the chair, and I have not opened it or inspected anything inside.
- 04 **Dev:** I will record that ² _____ without adding a contents description. A case designed for glasses does not prove what is actually inside it.
- 05 **Ana:** Correct. Please also keep the room number as two hundred fourteen. It could easily be confused with two hundred forty-one if someone writes it quickly.
- 06 **Dev:** I have the ³ _____ as beneath the chair in room 214. I will read that back before finishing the entry.
- 07 **Ana:** That is right. It was found after checkout, but I do not know who owns it. I do not want to attach a guest name by guessing.
- 08 **Dev:** We will keep ⁴ _____ unverified. The room and timing are useful facts, but they are not a completed identification of the person entitled to receive it.
- 09 **Ana:** Thank you. I can hand the closed case to you through the normal process now. Please confirm when it is actually in your custody.
- 10 **Dev:** I have received the case. That is the ⁵ _____ for this transfer. The record should show the real handover rather than an intention to pass it on later.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 46.

- 11 **Ana:** Good. I will not describe that as returned to the guest, because we have only moved it to the designated staff receiver.
- 12 **Dev:** Exactly. The ⁶ _____ describes this staff handover. Any later return is a separate event with its own verification and recording requirements.
- 13 **Ana:** Suppose someone later says they stayed in that room and asks whether we found anything. I should route that query through the actual process, correct?
- 14 **Dev:** Yes. An ⁷ _____ needs appropriate verification. We should not release an item simply because a caller supplies a room number or sounds confident.
- 15 **Ana:** And I should not discuss another guest's details while trying to help the caller. That would go beyond the information needed for this handover.
- 16 **Dev:** Correct. Keep the ⁸ _____ clear and use the designated process. Helpful service does not require giving an unverified caller someone else's personal information.
- 17 **Ana:** Could you repeat the entry once, so I can confirm that the location and the fact that I kept the case closed are both included?
- 18 **Dev:** The ⁹ _____ says closed black glasses case, found beneath the chair in room 214 after checkout, not opened by you, received by me.
- 19 **Ana:** That matches what happened. The staff transfer is complete, and we still do not have a verified owner or an authorized return to report.
- 20 **Dev:** Agreed. No ¹⁰ _____ to a claimant has occurred. We have completed and recorded the custody transfer while leaving the unresolved ownership question accurately open.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 85

1. lost-property receiver | 2. visible description | 3. find location | 4. ownership | 5. receipt confirmation | 6. custody record | 7. ownership claim | 8. privacy boundary | 9. property record | 10. release

Record a different found item

F Say it

A closed navy pouch is found on the desk in room 318 after checkout. Its owner is unknown. Designated receiver Rosa confirms receiving it unopened.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

desk / 318 / unknown / pouch

Attendant: "The item is a closed navy ¹ _____."

Receiver: "The find location is the ² _____."

Attendant: "The room number is ³ _____."

Receiver: "The owner remains ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 85

1. pouch | 2. desk | 3. 318 | 4. unknown

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Three bath towels short

A Read the situation

Report linen counts by item, calculate the exact shortfall, and separate expected delivery from stock on hand.

The third-floor cart target is twelve bath towels and eight hand towels. Attendant Noor counts nine bath towels and eight hand towels. A laundry delivery is expected but its arrival and contents are not confirmed. Supply lead Ben needs an item-specific report and a request for three additional bath towels, not a statement that all linen is unavailable. No delivery has been received or counted. The target is a cart-stock requirement, not a claim about the number of occupied rooms or a reason to substitute one towel type for another.

PEOPLE / Noor: Room attendant | Ben: Supply lead

06

SPECIFIC SHORTAGES ARE EASIER TO SOLVE

A broad statement such as we have no linen can cause unnecessary disruption. Name the cart, the towel type, the target, and the counted amount. Keep expected supplies out of the current count until the actual receipt and checks occur.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is the bath-towel shortfall?

- A Three
- C Twelve

- B Nine
- D Zero

2. What is the hand-towel status?

- A All hand towels missing
- C Delivery needed to establish the current count

- B Three short
- D Eight counted against a target of eight

3. What is known about the delivery?

- A It guarantees the cart is complete
- C It has arrived with three bath towels

- B It is expected but not confirmed
- D Its full contents were counted

Answers and explanations: page 86.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

linen

Textile items used in housekeeping, such as towels and bedding.

IN USE count the linen

bath towel

Larger towel intended for drying the body after bathing.

IN USE replenish bath towels

hand towel

Smaller towel intended primarily for drying hands.

IN USE count hand towels

bath mat

Textile or other item used on the floor near bathing facilities.

IN USE identify the bath mat

pillowcase

Cover used over a pillow.

IN USE replenish pillowcases

duvet cover

Removable fabric cover for a duvet.

IN USE count duvet covers

flat sheet

Unfitted bed sheet without shaped elastic corners.

IN USE identify a flat sheet

fitted sheet

Sheet designed to fit around a mattress.

IN USE check fitted-sheet stock

linen cart

Mobile storage unit carrying linen supplies.

IN USE replenish the linen cart

floor allocation

Supplies assigned to a particular building floor.

IN USE check the floor allocation

stock target

Quantity specified as the desired amount on hand.

IN USE confirm the stock target

par level

Planned stock level used for replenishment decisions.

IN USE compare with par level

06

Precision check

Bath towels: target twelve, counted nine, short three. Hand towels: target eight, counted eight, no numerical shortfall. Keep item types separate even when giving a combined cart total.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

physical count

Quantity actually counted at the location.

IN USE complete a physical count

stock on hand

Supplies currently present, not merely expected.

IN USE report stock on hand

shortfall

Amount by which the current count is below the target.

IN USE calculate the shortfall

item type

Category of supply that must remain distinct in the count.

IN USE specify the item type

replenishment request

Request to restore the required stock.

IN USE submit a replenishment request

laundry delivery

Transfer of linen from the laundry supply process.

IN USE check the laundry delivery

expected delivery

Delivery anticipated but not yet confirmed as received.

IN USE distinguish an expected delivery

confirmed receipt

Established arrival and acceptance under the relevant process.

IN USE record confirmed receipt

delivery contents

Items and quantities actually included in a delivery.

IN USE verify delivery contents

count discrepancy

Difference between a recorded or expected amount and a checked count.

IN USE report a count discrepancy

substitution

Replacement of one item type with another under the required approval.

IN USE avoid an unapproved substitution

stock update

Revised statement of actual inventory after a verified change.

IN USE provide a stock update

Precision check

Expected delivery is not stock on hand. The delivery may need arrival, contents, and other required checks before the cart record changes. Do not convert an anticipated delivery into a completed replenishment.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

IDENTIFY THE CART

"This is the third-floor linen cart."

GIVE THE COUNT

"I counted nine bath towels."

REPORT THE SECOND ITEM

"Hand towels are eight against a target of eight."

REQUEST THE EXACT AMOUNT

"Please arrange three additional bath towels."

STATE THE TARGET

"The target is twelve bath towels."

CALCULATE THE GAP

"We are three bath towels short."

AVOID OVERSTATEMENT

"The shortage is not across all linen."

PRESERVE UNCERTAINTY

"The laundry delivery is expected but not confirmed."

Against

Nine against twelve compares actual stock with the target.

Short by

Short by three describes the missing amount, not the amount present.

On hand

This means actually available in the stated location.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

KEEP FUTURE STOCK SEPARATE

"I have not added expected items to the current count."

CLARIFY CONTENTS

"Do we know what the delivery contains?"

UPDATE AFTER VERIFICATION

"I will revise the count after the actual receipt and checks."

NAME THE REMAINING NEED

"The bath-towel shortfall remains open."

ASK ABOUT RECEIPT

"Has the delivery actually arrived and been checked?"

REJECT A SILENT SUBSTITUTE

"Hand towels are not an assumed replacement for bath towels."

KEEP THE UNIT VISIBLE

"Three bath towels, not three carts or packs."

CLOSE THE COUNT REPORT

"Nine bath towels and eight hand towels are currently counted."

06

Expected

Expected is weaker than arrived, received, or counted.

Additional

Three additional bath towels would fill the numerical gap if actually received and accepted.

By item

Separate categories prevent a correct total from hiding the wrong mix.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which report is best?

- A** Nine of twelve bath towels; eight of eight hand towels; three bath towels short.
- B** We have no linen.
- C** We are twelve towels short.
- D** The expected delivery completes the cart.

2. Why not count the expected delivery?

- A** Hand towels must replace every missing item.
- B** The target has automatically changed.
- C** Its arrival and contents are unconfirmed.
- D** Deliveries can never replenish stock.

3. Which request matches the shortfall?

- A** Eight additional bath towels
- B** Three unspecified containers
- C** Three additional bath towels
- D** Twelve additional hand towels

4. What does the cart target establish?

- A** Twelve occupied rooms
- B** Eight guests on the floor
- C** Permission to substitute any linen
- D** A required stock mix, not the number of occupied rooms

Answers and explanations: [page 86](#).

Three bath towels short

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

shortfall / delivery contents / stock target / Stock on hand / replenishment request / expected delivery / stock update / substitution / physical count / linen cart

06

- 01 **Noor:** I have counted the third-floor linen cart. The bath towels are below target, but the hand towels match their target.
- 02 **Ben:** Please give me the ¹ _____ and the target for each type. I want the item-specific figures before arranging replenishment.
- 03 **Noor:** The target is twelve bath towels, and I counted nine. For hand towels, the target is eight and the count is also eight.
- 04 **Ben:** That gives a ² _____ of three bath towels. The hand towels have no numerical gap against their target, so the two categories need different status messages.
- 05 **Noor:** Exactly. I do not want the handover to say the whole floor has no linen, because that would not describe what I counted.
- 06 **Ben:** We should name the ³ _____ and the two item types. This is the third-floor cart report, not a claim about every cupboard or every floor.
- 07 **Noor:** A laundry delivery is expected, but I have not seen it arrive. I also do not know the quantities or items it will contain.
- 08 **Ben:** Then it remains an ⁴ _____. We cannot use it to close the bath-towel shortage until the actual supply and relevant checks are established.
- 09 **Noor:** I have kept it out of the current count. I do not want to report twelve just because a delivery may be on the way.
- 10 **Ben:** Correct. ⁵ _____ remains nine bath towels and eight hand towels. An expected arrival is useful planning information, but it is not counted stock.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 55.

- 11 **Noor:** Please arrange three more bath towels for this cart. I mean individual bath towels, not three packs with an unknown quantity in each.
- 12 **Ben:** I will make the ⁶ _____ for three additional bath towels. Keeping the unit explicit prevents us from ordering or recording an unintended quantity.
- 13 **Noor:** Should we describe the hand towels as an alternative? There are eight here, but those eight already match their own target.
- 14 **Ben:** No ⁷ _____ has been approved. A hand towel and a bath towel are different stock items, and the present count does not authorize changing the required mix.
- 15 **Noor:** Understood. When the delivery does arrive, I will need to check what it actually includes rather than assume it contains the missing bath towels.
- 16 **Ben:** Yes, verify the ⁸ _____ through the normal process. An arrival by itself does not establish that the three needed bath towels are in it.
- 17 **Noor:** Until then, the shortage stays open. I can give another update after the actual receipt and checks, using the resulting count.
- 18 **Ben:** That is when the ⁹ _____ should change the recorded figures. We should preserve the earlier count rather than retroactively pretend the cart was already full.
- 19 **Noor:** My final read-back is third-floor cart: nine bath towels against twelve, eight hand towels against eight, with three bath towels still needed.
- 20 **Ben:** Agreed. The ¹⁰ _____ remains twelve and eight respectively. The delivery is expected, not confirmed, and the request is for three additional bath towels.

06

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 87

1. physical count | 2. shortfall | 3. linen cart | 4. expected delivery | 5. Stock on hand | 6. replenishment request | 7. substitution | 8. delivery contents | 9. stock update | 10. stock target

Calculate another linen shortfall

F Say it

The second-floor cart target is ten bath towels and six hand towels. The count is seven bath towels and six hand towels. A delivery is expected but not confirmed.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

06

WORD + PHRASE BANK

six / three / seven / ten

Attendant: "The bath-towel target is ¹ _____."

Lead: "The counted bath towels total ² _____."

Attendant: "We need ³ _____ additional bath towels."

Lead: "The hand-towel count is ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 87

1. ten | 2. seven | 3. three | 4. six

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Streaks beside office 8

A Read the situation

Acknowledge a reported result, identify the exact surface, and arrange a check without inventing the cause or outcome.

Client Dana reports streaks on the interior glass panel beside office 8, which was cleaned earlier today. Cleaner Malik has not yet checked the reported area with the client. Dana is available to point out the panel. Lead Rosa can arrange a check and appropriate rework through the site process. The cause is unknown, and no rework or final inspection is complete. Malik needs to acknowledge the concern, locate it precisely, and explain the next step without denying the report, blaming someone, or promising a result and time that have not been verified.

PEOPLE / Dana: Client contact | Malik: Cleaner

07

ACKNOWLEDGE THE RESULT BEFORE EXPLAINING THE PROCESS

Saying we already cleaned it may sound like a refusal to listen. Recognize the reported concern first, then clarify the surface and arrange the check. An acknowledgement does not require guessing a technical cause or admitting a fault that has not been established.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which surface is reported?

- A Every glass surface in the building
- C Interior glass panel beside office 8

- B The floor inside office 18
- D Exterior window above office 8

2. What is known about the cause?

- A Wrong product is confirmed
- C Permanent damage is established

- B The client caused the streaks
- D It is unknown

3. What can Dana do now?

- A Authorize every chemical procedure
- C Supply a finished inspection result

- B Confirm completed rework
- D Point out the panel

Answers and explanations: [page 88](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

quality concern

Report that a result may not meet the required standard.

IN USE acknowledge a quality concern

streak

Visible line or mark remaining across a surface.

IN USE report streaks on glass

smear

Spread or blurred mark on a surface.

IN USE describe a smear

residue

Material remaining after an activity or substance has been removed.

IN USE identify residue

haze

Cloudy appearance that reduces surface clarity.

IN USE describe a haze

scratch

Mark or damage caused by abrasion or contact.

IN USE distinguish a scratch from residue

interior glass

Glass surface on the inside of a building or assembly.

IN USE identify interior glass

glass panel

Defined sheet or section of glass.

IN USE locate the glass panel

partition

Structure dividing areas within a space.

IN USE identify the partition

frame

Surrounding support or border of a panel.

IN USE distinguish the frame from glass

edge

Boundary of a surface or object.

IN USE identify the affected edge

finish

Visible or specified final condition of a surface.

IN USE assess the finish

Precision check

Streaks are the reported result. They do not prove the wrong product, permanent damage, or who caused the problem. Acknowledge the report and identify the panel before discussing what the actual check establishes.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

inspection

Examination against the relevant requirements.

IN USE arrange an inspection

rework

Additional work to correct a result that does not meet requirements.

IN USE arrange appropriate rework

verification check

Check that the specified result has actually been achieved.

IN USE complete a verification check

reported result

Outcome described by the person raising the concern.

IN USE acknowledge the reported result

direct observation

Information obtained by seeing or otherwise directly checking the matter.

IN USE distinguish direct observation

cause analysis

Investigation of why a result occurred.

IN USE separate cause analysis from acknowledgement

service standard

Required level or condition of the provided service.

IN USE check the service standard

client feedback

Information from the client about the service received.

IN USE receive client feedback

follow-up arrangement

Agreed method or responsibility for the next action.

IN USE confirm a follow-up arrangement

completion claim

Statement that work has been finished.

IN USE avoid an unsupported completion claim

resolution

Established outcome that addresses the issue through the actual process.

IN USE confirm resolution

update commitment

Promise to provide information about progress, not a guaranteed result.

IN USE make an update commitment

Precision check

Cleaned earlier is a past activity, not proof of the present finish. Rework arranged, rework completed, and result verified are different stages. Report the real stage without promising a perfect finish or an unchecked completion time.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE THE CONCERN

"Thank you for pointing out the streaks."

IDENTIFY THE PANEL

"Is it the interior glass beside office 8?"

AVOID DISMISSING THE REPORT

"The earlier cleaning does not answer your concern about the current result."

INVOLVE THE LEAD

"I will ask Rosa to arrange a check."

RECOGNIZE THE INCONVENIENCE

"I am sorry the result is not as expected."

ASK FOR A PRECISE INDICATION

"Could you point out the affected area?"

SEPARATE THE CAUSE

"I do not know what caused the marks yet."

EXPLAIN THE NEXT STAGE

"The check will establish what appropriate rework is needed."

07

Reported

This attributes the observation accurately when the worker has not yet checked it.

Earlier today

A time reference does not establish the present quality of the result.

Beside

Keep the location relation precise, especially around numbered offices.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

AVOID A GUESSED REMEDY

"I will not choose a method before the relevant assessment."

KEEP STATUS ACCURATE

"Rework has not been completed yet."

AVOID A TIME PROMISE

"I do not have a checked completion estimate."

PRESERVE THE LOCATION

"Interior panel beside office 8, not the exterior window."

ACKNOWLEDGE AVAILABILITY

"Thank you for being available to show us the panel."

PROMISE AN UPDATE

"I will pass on the checked next step."

SEPARATE DONE AND VERIFIED

"A completion report still needs the required verification."

CLOSE THE RESPONSE

"I have the concern and location; Rosa will receive the follow-up request."

Arrange versus complete

Arranging rework does not mean the corrective work has happened.

Yet

The cause is unknown yet; do not fill the gap with blame.

Sorry

An apology for inconvenience need not invent a diagnosis or technical admission.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which opening is most useful?

- A** The glass is permanently damaged.
- B** Thank you for pointing it out; could you show me the interior panel beside office 8?
- C** We cleaned it, so there cannot be streaks.
- D** You must have touched it.

2. What does cleaned earlier establish?

- A** A confirmed product error
- B** A past cleaning activity, not verified current quality
- C** Guaranteed absence of marks
- D** Completed rework after the complaint

3. Which next step fits the brief?

- A** Mark the complaint resolved immediately
- B** Ask Rosa to arrange a check and appropriate rework
- C** Promise a perfect finish in five minutes
- D** Select a chemical method without assessment

4. Which statement falsely closes the issue?

- A** The cause remains unknown.
- B** The follow-up needs a check.
- C** The panel is now verified clear because the client reported it.
- D** Dana can point out the panel.

Answers and explanations: [page 88](#).

Streaks beside office 8

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

inspection / verification check / quality concern / interior glass / streaks / resolution / Rework / reported result / update commitment / follow-up arrangement

07

- 01 **Dana:** There are streaks on the glass beside office eight. I know it was cleaned earlier today, but the result still does not look right.
- 02 **Malik:** Thank you for pointing out the ¹ _____. I am sorry the result is not as expected. Could you show me which panel and area you mean?
- 03 **Dana:** It is the interior panel beside the office, not the outside window. I can point it out when someone comes to check.
- 04 **Malik:** I will keep ² _____ in the description. Beside office eight is the location, and I understand you are available to show the affected part.
- 05 **Dana:** Yes. I am not asking you to guess why it happened. I just want someone to look at the streaks and deal with them appropriately.
- 06 **Malik:** Understood. The ³ _____ is streaking on that panel. I have not yet checked it with you, and I do not know the cause.
- 07 **Dana:** Someone might tell me it has already been cleaned. That would not really answer the concern I am raising about how it looks now.
- 08 **Malik:** I agree. Earlier cleaning is an activity, not a completed ⁴ _____ of the present finish. Your concern still needs the appropriate follow-up.
- 09 **Dana:** Who can arrange that follow-up? I would like to know where the request is going rather than repeat it to several different people.
- 10 **Malik:** Rosa is our lead. I will ask her to arrange an ⁵ _____ of the identified panel and the appropriate rework through the site process.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 64.

- 11 **Dana:** Thank you. Please do not tell her I said the glass was scratched. I said there were streaks, and I do not know more than that.
- 12 **Malik:** I will preserve ⁶ _____ as the description. I will not change your report into a claim of permanent damage or a particular product fault.
- 13 **Dana:** That is important. Can you give me a time for the correction, or does the lead need to check the current schedule first?
- 14 **Malik:** I do not have a checked completion estimate. I can make an ⁷ _____ to pass on the next step, but I should not invent a finishing time.
- 15 **Dana:** That is reasonable. I would rather receive a realistic update than be told it is fixed before anyone has looked at the panel.
- 16 **Malik:** Yes. ⁸ _____ needs to be appropriate to the checked condition and actual site requirements. Arranging it is not the same as completing it.
- 17 **Dana:** Please also keep the location precise when you report it. We have several panels nearby, and I do not want the wrong one checked.
- 18 **Malik:** The ⁹ _____ will name the interior glass panel beside office eight. I will include that you can point out the area with the reported marks.
- 19 **Dana:** Good. I have given you the concern and can help identify it. I am waiting for the check and the appropriate response, not a guess.
- 20 **Malik:** Thank you. I will not report ¹⁰ _____ before the work and required verification are complete. For now, I am passing the accurate concern and location to Rosa.

07

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 89

1. quality concern | 2. interior glass | 3. reported result | 4. verification check | 5. inspection | 6. streaks | 7. update commitment | 8. Rework | 9. follow-up arrangement | 10. resolution

Respond to another reported finish

F Say it

A client reports smears on the interior panel beside office 12. Lead Ben can arrange a check. The cause is unknown, and no rework has been completed.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

smears / unknown / 12 / Ben

Cleaner: "The reported marks are ¹ _____."

Client: "The panel is beside office ² _____."

Cleaner: "The lead for the check is ³ _____."

Cleaner: "The cause remains ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 89

1. smears | 2. 12 | 3. Ben | 4. unknown

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Three rooms, different stages

A Read the situation

Report each room status separately, assign the unfinished steps, and avoid confusing cleaning with inspection or release.

At the end of the shift, attendant Tessa hands over rooms 301, 302, and 303 to incoming attendant Arun. Rooms 301 and 302 have been cleaned. Room 302 still awaits inspection by supervisor Rosa. Room 303 was inaccessible and has not been cleaned. Arun can accept the access follow-up for 303; Rosa owns the inspection of 302. The handover does not establish room-release decisions or an inspection result for 301. No new room entry, completed inspection, or completed cleaning of 303 occurs during this conversation.

PEOPLE / Tessa: Outgoing room attendant | Arun: Incoming room attendant

08

PRECISION SURVIVES A SHIFT CHANGE

A short list can carry more useful information than a general all done message. Repeat each room number with its actual stage and the person responsible for the next step. Receiving the list should make ownership clear without upgrading an unfinished status.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which rooms have been cleaned?

A 301 and 302

B All three rooms

C Only 303

D No rooms

2. What remains for 302?

A Cleaning confirmed as never started

B A guest-release decision already made

C Arun's access follow-up for 303

D Rosa's inspection

3. What is the status of 303?

A Inaccessible and not cleaned; access follow-up can pass to Arun

B Cleaned and inspected

C Released to a guest

D Automatically accessible after handover

Answers and explanations: page 90.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

room status

Current recorded state of a guest room.

IN USE report room status

cleaned

Cleaning task completed, distinct from later inspection or release.

IN USE mark the room cleaned

awaiting inspection

Cleaning completed but the required inspection not yet performed.

IN USE retain awaiting-inspection status

inaccessible

Not available for authorized entry or work at the relevant time.

IN USE report an inaccessible room

not cleaned

Cleaning has not been carried out.

IN USE preserve not-cleaned status

room release

Authorization making a room available for the intended use.

IN USE verify room release

inspection owner

Person responsible for the pending inspection.

IN USE name the inspection owner

access follow-up

Task of checking and resolving access through the actual procedure.

IN USE accept an access follow-up

room-status board

Shared display or record of room stages.

IN USE update the room-status board

handover log

Record of transferred work and current status.

IN USE maintain the handover log

outgoing shift

Team or work period passing responsibility onward.

IN USE brief the outgoing shift

incoming shift

Team or work period taking over responsibility.

IN USE brief the incoming shift

Precision check

Cleaned is not a synonym for inspected or released. Room 302 illustrates the difference: cleaning is complete, but inspection is pending. Room 303 has not been cleaned at all because access was unavailable.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

outstanding task

Required work that remains unfinished.

IN USE identify an outstanding task

task acceptance

Agreement to take responsibility for a task.

IN USE confirm task acceptance

completion evidence

Information establishing that work actually occurred.

IN USE require completion evidence

status transition

Change from one recorded stage to another after the relevant event.

IN USE verify a status transition

inspection result

Actual finding or outcome of the room check.

IN USE record the inspection result

release authority

Person or process entitled to authorize the next use.

IN USE confirm release authority

access restriction

Condition limiting entry or work in an area.

IN USE preserve an access restriction

room identifier

Number or other detail distinguishing the room.

IN USE repeat the room identifier

follow-up priority

Relative order or urgency assigned to unfinished tasks.

IN USE clarify follow-up priority

exception report

Record of a task or condition outside the expected completed state.

IN USE submit an exception report

carryover work

Unfinished work transferred to the next shift.

IN USE track carryover work

separate status

Distinct recorded state for each room or task.

IN USE preserve separate statuses

08

Precision check

The handover supplies only a cleaned status for room 301. Do not invent either a passed inspection or a failed one. A room-release decision must come from the actual authorized process, not from the absence of a problem in a short report.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

START THE ROOM LIST

"I have separate updates for 301, 302, and 303."

AVOID AN INVENTED RESULT

"I have no inspection result for 301 to add."

NAME THE INSPECTION OWNER

"Rosa owns the inspection for 302."

PRESERVE THE CONSEQUENCE

"Room 303 has not been cleaned."

STATE THE FIRST FACT

"Room 301 has been cleaned."

STATE THE SECOND STAGE

"Room 302 is cleaned and awaiting inspection."

STATE THE ACCESS ISSUE

"Room 303 was inaccessible."

ASSIGN FOLLOW-UP

"Can you take the access follow-up for 303?"

08

Cleaned versus ready

Ready may imply more than cleaning; name the actual completed stage.

Awaiting

Awaiting inspection explicitly identifies a pending next step.

Was inaccessible

This explains the earlier condition but does not prove present access has changed.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

ACCEPT WITHOUT OVERCLAIMING

"I accept the follow-up; access is not resolved yet."

AVOID AUTOMATIC RELEASE

"This handover does not authorize room release."

UPDATE BY EVENT

"Change the status only when the relevant work or decision occurs."

CONFIRM THE RECORD

"The handover log should match these separate statuses."

KEEP ENTRY SEPARATE

"The actual access procedure still applies."

REPEAT THE UNFINISHED WORK

"Inspection for 302 and access follow-up for 303 remain open."

KEEP ROOM NUMBERS ATTACHED

"Please record each stage against the correct room."

CLOSE WITH OWNERSHIP

"Rosa has the inspection; you have the access follow-up."

08

Accepted versus completed

A receiving worker can accept responsibility while work remains unfinished.

No result supplied

Missing information is not evidence of either passing or failing an inspection.

Separate entries

Keep each room number attached to its own state and next owner.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which summary is accurate?

- A** 302 inspected because Rosa is responsible.
- B** 301 cleaned; 302 cleaned, inspection pending; 303 inaccessible and not cleaned.
- C** All three rooms ready.
- D** 303 cleaned because Arun accepted it.

2. What does Arun accept?

- A** A completed inspection result for 302
- B** Proof 303 is already clean
- C** Access follow-up for 303
- D** Authority to release every room

3. What can be said about 301's inspection?

- A** No result is supplied in this handover.
- B** It definitely passed.
- C** It definitely failed.
- D** Arun automatically inspected it while listening.

4. When should a status change?

- A** As soon as a new shift arrives
- B** When someone repeats the room number
- C** Before the required inspection to save time
- D** After the relevant actual work or authorized decision

Answers and explanations: page 90.

Three rooms, different stages

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

Room release / awaiting inspection / status transition / handover log / cleaned / inspection owner / separate status / not cleaned / access follow-up / task acceptance

08

- 01 **Tessa:** Before I finish, I need to hand over three rooms with different statuses. Please do not combine them into a single all-done entry.
- 02 **Arun:** I am ready to take the ¹ _____ details. Give me each room number with what has actually happened and what remains for the next person.
- 03 **Tessa:** Room three hundred one has been cleaned. I have no inspection result or room-release decision to add to that statement.
- 04 **Arun:** I will record ² _____ for 301 without inventing another stage. The absence of an inspection result in this message does not mean I can assume one.
- 05 **Tessa:** Room three hundred two has also been cleaned, but it still awaits Rosa's inspection. That unfinished step needs to remain visible.
- 06 **Arun:** So 302 is ³ _____, with cleaning complete. I will keep that distinction on the room-status record instead of shortening it to ready.
- 07 **Tessa:** Exactly. Rosa remains responsible for that inspection. I am not transferring the inspection to you merely because you are receiving this handover.
- 08 **Arun:** Rosa is the ⁴ _____. I can carry the status forward, but I should not report that she has already completed the check.
- 09 **Tessa:** Room three hundred three was inaccessible, so it has not been cleaned. Can you take the access follow-up through the actual procedure?
- 10 **Arun:** Yes, I accept the ⁵ _____ for 303. That means I will address the access question through the proper route, not enter just because the shift has changed.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 73.

- 11 **Tessa:** Thank you. Please keep not cleaned on the record until the work has really happened. The access issue explains why it was unfinished.
- 12 **Arun:** I will preserve the ⁶ _____ status. A planned follow-up is not completion evidence, and I will not upgrade the room based on an intention.
- 13 **Tessa:** Good. If someone asks whether all three rooms can be released, this handover alone does not supply that decision for any of them.
- 14 **Arun:** Understood. ⁷ _____ belongs to the actual authorized process. I will not substitute our conversation for the required inspection or release decision.
- 15 **Tessa:** Could you repeat the two unfinished tasks and their owners? I want to be sure they remain separate when you update the shared record.
- 16 **Arun:** Rosa has the inspection for 302; I have the access follow-up for 303. That is my ⁸ _____, not a report that either outstanding task is finished.
- 17 **Tessa:** That is accurate. Room 301 is reported cleaned only. Please do not borrow 302's inspection status and apply it to 301 without information.
- 18 **Arun:** I will keep a ⁹ _____ for each room. Shared numbering does not make the stages identical, and an unknown result should remain unknown.
- 19 **Tessa:** Thank you. Once the actual follow-up or inspection happens, the person handling it can provide the real outcome for the correct room.
- 20 **Arun:** Yes. Each ¹⁰ _____ will follow the relevant event. For now: 301 cleaned, 302 cleaned and awaiting Rosa's inspection, 303 inaccessible and not cleaned, with access follow-up assigned to me.

08

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 91

1. handover log | 2. cleaned | 3. awaiting inspection | 4. inspection owner | 5. access follow-up | 6. not cleaned | 7. Room release | 8. task acceptance | 9. separate status | 10. status transition

Hand over another room sequence

F Say it

Room 410 is cleaned. Room 411 is cleaned and awaits inspection by Ben. Room 412 was inaccessible and is not cleaned. Incoming attendant Jo accepts the access follow-up for 412.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

Jo / 411 / 412 / Ben

08

Outgoing: "The room awaiting inspection is ¹ _____."

Incoming: "The inspection owner is ² _____."

Outgoing: "The inaccessible, uncleaned room is ³ _____."

Incoming: "The access follow-up has been accepted by ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 91

1. 411 | 2. Ben | 3. 412 | 4. Jo

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

01 Briefing and language checks

Confirming the assignment and its limits

A Briefing checks / page 4

1. What is Maya assigned to clean?

C. Table surfaces and the floor

The assignment specifically covers table surfaces and the floor, with stated exclusions.

2. Who can clarify extra work?

D. Supervisor Rosa

Rosa is identified as the supervisor who can handle changes through the site process.

3. What does the 3:00 meeting establish?

C. A stated time constraint, not expanded permission

The meeting time describes urgency but does not change the authorized scope.

D Language checks / page 9

1. Which response is clearest?

C. My assignment covers the tables and floor; I will check the extra work with Rosa.

The response preserves scope and gives a practical route for the additional request.

2. Which statement wrongly treats urgency as permission?

D. The meeting is at three, so high windows are now authorized.

A time constraint does not authorize an excluded task or change the assignment.

3. What should Maya avoid promising?

B. Completion of every requested extra before three

No approval or feasibility check supports a promise to complete all additional work.

4. Why clarify tables?

A. Objects on a table may be outside the assigned surface-cleaning scope.

Table-surface work does not itself authorize handling personal devices resting on the table.

01 Conversation answers

Confirming the assignment and its limits

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 10-11

1. assignment. Turn 2. Assignment identifies the work currently allocated: table surfaces and floor, not every requested addition.

2. scope of work. Turn 4. Scope of work defines the included tasks and boundaries; table surfaces do not automatically include personal equipment.

3. additional work. Turn 6. Additional work is outside the current assignment and needs clarification rather than automatic inclusion because of urgency.

4. site supervisor. Turn 8. The site supervisor is the identified person who can clarify and authorize changes through the actual site process.

5. clarification request. Turn 10. A clarification request seeks a defined decision about the extra tasks without implying the answer is already yes.

6. task list. Turn 12. The task list provides the confirmed included work and should not be enlarged in a message to another person.

7. surface access. Turn 14. Surface access includes the practical and authorized arrangement for reaching the table without assuming permission to handle belongings.

8. approved change. Turn 16. An approved change is a modification actually accepted through the relevant process, unlike the still-pending request.

9. deadline. Turn 18. Deadline names the time requirement but does not establish authorization, resources, or a reliable completion promise.

10. read-back. Turn 20. Read-back repeats the confirmed scope and pending request, checking that both people share the same understanding.

F Transfer conversation

Page 12

1. counters

Cleaner: "The assigned horizontal surfaces are the reception counters."

Counters are the named surfaces included in this work order.

2. signs

Client: "The additional request concerns the exterior signs."

Exterior signs are the requested addition, not an already included task.

3. Leon

Cleaner: "I will ask Leon to review the request."

Leon is the supervisor identified for reviewing any proposed change.

4. approved

Cleaner: "The extra work is not yet approved."

The brief explicitly states that approval has not been given.

02 Briefing and language checks

Respecting access and occupied spaces

A Briefing checks / page 13

1. Why is cleaning declined at 10:00?

A. The guest is on a call until about 11:00

The stated reason is the call, not a permanent cancellation of service.

2. What return window is available?

B. 11:15-11:30

Lina's actual available return window begins at eleven fifteen and ends at eleven thirty.

3. What does Alex choose?

C. The return window, without towels now

Alex chooses the later offered window and declines the separate towel option.

D Language checks / page 18

1. Which read-back is accurate?

A. Return between 11:15 and 11:30; no towels requested now.

The read-back preserves the chosen window and declined towel option.

2. What does the call ending at eleven establish?

C. Expected availability information, not automatic entry permission

An expected end time does not replace the actual room-access procedure.

3. Which offer is within Lina's stated options?

C. Fresh towels at the door now

Doorstep towels are one of the two explicitly available choices.

4. Why record the exact window?

D. To avoid turning a time range into a different appointment

Recording both endpoints prevents a later worker from assuming an unsupported exact arrival time.

02 Conversation answers

Respecting access and occupied spaces

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 19-20

- 1. declined service.** Turn 2. Declined service describes the current ten-o'clock visit, not a cancellation of every future cleaning opportunity.
- 2. return window.** Turn 4. Return window is the actual offered interval, eleven fifteen to eleven thirty, rather than an exact eleven-o'clock appointment.
- 3. fresh towels.** Turn 6. Fresh towels are the separate available service option that can be handed over at the door now.
- 4. guest preference.** Turn 8. Guest preference is the chosen later visit, with no separate towel delivery requested at the present time.
- 5. time range.** Turn 10. Time range preserves both endpoints and prevents the plan from becoming an unsupported exact arrival promise.
- 6. entry procedure.** Turn 12. Entry procedure remains necessary at the actual visit; this scheduling conversation does not by itself authorize entry.
- 7. availability.** Turn 14. Availability concerns when the guest may be free; it is separate from verified room status or permission to enter.
- 8. service deferral.** Turn 16. Service deferral means moving the visit later, accurately reflecting the guest's choice rather than permanent cancellation.
- 9. visit plan.** Turn 18. Visit plan links the correct room to the chosen return window and does not report that cleaning has already occurred.
- 10. confirmation.** Turn 20. Confirmation establishes agreement on the stated plan, while actual entry permission and completed service remain separate questions.

F Transfer conversation

Page 21

- 1. 420**
Attendant: "This plan is for room 420."
Room 420 is the identifier supplied for the new visit plan.
- 2. 10:00**
Guest: "The call is expected to finish at 10:00."
Ten o'clock is the expected call end, not the promised return.
- 3. 10:30-10:45**
Attendant: "The return window is 10:30-10:45."
The offered and chosen window runs from ten thirty to ten forty-five.
- 4. access procedure**
Attendant: "Entry still follows the actual access procedure."
Scheduling the visit does not remove the site's entry requirements.

03 Briefing and language checks

Clarifying product and task information

03

A Briefing checks / page 22

1. What is wrong with the bottle?

A. Its label is unreadable

The visible problem is an unreadable label, leaving identity unconfirmed.

2. Why is color insufficient here?

B. Two products use similar bottles

Similar bottles make appearance an unreliable basis for identifying this product.

3. What can Ben arrange?

B. Proper identification and information, or an identified replacement

Ben is the named supervisor able to resolve identity through the actual site process.

D Language checks / page 27

1. Which response challenges the shortcut constructively?

B. Two products look similar; let us ask Ben to verify this one.

The response gives the factual reason for doubt and a proper clarification route.

2. Which document is relevant?

B. The safety data sheet matching the actual product

Safety information needs to correspond to the identified product rather than an approximate match.

3. Which statement is unsupported?

B. This product is approved for the surface because the bottle looks familiar.

Familiar appearance does not establish product identity or suitability for the task.

4. What should remain clear in the handoff?

D. Identity unresolved and product unused

The handoff must preserve the actual uncertainty and stopped-use status supplied.

03 Conversation answers

Clarifying product and task information

03

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 28-29

- 1. looks like.** Turn 2. Looks like expresses visual resemblance, which is weaker than verified identity when two products use similar bottles.
- 2. product identifier.** Turn 4. Product identifier is the reliable name or code needed to connect the container with the correct product information.
- 3. unreadable label.** Turn 6. Unreadable label is the observed problem that prevents reliable identification, rather than an assumed chemical fault.
- 4. product information.** Turn 8. Product information must relate to the identified product and task; a name alone does not explain all relevant requirements.
- 5. safety data sheet.** Turn 10. Safety data sheet expands SDS and identifies the document describing the product's hazards and related safety information.
- 6. identified replacement.** Turn 12. An identified replacement offers a product with established identity and information, not a second uncertain container.
- 7. Surface compatibility.** Turn 14. Surface compatibility concerns whether the identified product suits the actual material; products are not interchangeable merely because both clean.
- 8. dilution.** Turn 16. Dilution instructions are product-specific requirements that must be verified rather than invented from past experience.
- 9. unused.** Turn 18. Unused states the actual status of this bottle in Farah's task; the message must not invent use or exposure.
- 10. clarification.** Turn 20. Clarification resolves a specific uncertainty before action; receiving unclear information does not itself establish understanding or permission.

F Transfer conversation

Page 30

1. C

Worker: "The affected bottle is on cart C."

Cart C is the stated location of the unidentified bottle.

2. unreadable

Worker: "The label is unreadable."

Unreadable describes the observed label problem preventing reliable identification.

3. Leon

Colleague: "The lead for this query is Leon."

Leon is the named lead who can arrange the check.

4. unused

Worker: "The product remains unused."

Ana has not used the bottle, so that status must remain clear.

04 Briefing and language checks

Reporting faults and unsafe access

04

A Briefing checks / page 31

1. Where is the water?

D. Outside washroom B, beside the east stair door

The brief supplies both the washroom identifier and the east-door landmark.

2. What does Ravi know about the source?

A. It is unknown

Ravi has observed water but has not established its source.

3. What is the readiness status?

B. The affected area has not been declared ready

Reporting the condition does not establish completed controls or clearance.

D Language checks / page 36

1. Which message is most precise?

B. Water outside washroom B, beside the east stair door; source unknown.

The message supplies the exact location and preserves uncertainty about the source.

2. Which inference is not supported?

D. The water definitely comes from a broken pipe.

An observed wet floor does not establish a particular plumbing cause.

3. What does report acknowledgement mean?

C. The message was received, not that the area is cleared

Acknowledgement confirms receipt only and must not be confused with operational clearance.

4. What should a follow-up preserve?

D. Location, observed condition, unknown source, and current readiness status

These four details maintain an accurate and usable report without unsupported conclusions.

04 Conversation answers

Reporting faults and unsafe access

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 37-38

1. outside washroom B. Turn 2. Outside washroom B identifies the specific side and room, narrowing the location beyond a general washroom area.

2. east stair door. Turn 4. East stair door is the supplied landmark and direction, preventing confusion with another stair entrance.

3. source. Turn 6. Source means the origin of the water, which has not been determined from the visible condition.

4. hazard report. Turn 8. Hazard report is the communication already made under site arrangements; it does not establish completed response or clearance.

5. clearance. Turn 10. Clearance is the required authorization to return an area to the specified use; none is established here.

6. observed condition. Turn 12. Observed condition is the visible water at the named location, not a theory about how it arrived.

7. fault diagnosis. Turn 14. Fault diagnosis requires a determination beyond this observation; the cleaner has not established a plumbing failure.

8. report acknowledgement. Turn 16. Report acknowledgement confirms receipt of the information only, not completion of cleanup, repair, or inspection.

9. status update. Turn 18. Status update must preserve the current unresolved condition and absence of readiness rather than imply progress not established.

10. affected area. Turn 20. Affected area identifies the particular location requiring continued attention; it must not be replaced by a vague building-wide statement.

F Transfer conversation

Page 39

1. D

Cleaner: "The water is outside washroom D."

Washroom D is the exact room identifier in the new report.

2. west

Supervisor: "The landmark is the west service door."

West identifies the correct service door rather than another direction.

3. unknown

Cleaner: "The source remains unknown."

The visible condition does not establish where the water originated.

4. ready

Supervisor: "The area is not declared ready."

Reporting the condition does not provide a readiness declaration or clearance.

04

05 Briefing and language checks

Handling found items and privacy questions

A Briefing checks / page 40

1. Where was the case found?

C. Beneath the chair in room 214

Both the room number and the position beneath the chair are supplied.

2. What is known about the owner?

A. The owner is unknown

No ownership verification is supplied, so the room location cannot identify the owner.

3. Who is the designated receiver?

B. Dev

Dev is specifically identified as the receiver under the site found-property process.

D Language checks / page 45

1. Which description is supported?

D. Closed black glasses case beneath the chair in room 214

The supported description stays within visible details and the stated location.

2. What does Dev's receipt establish?

B. Transfer to the designated receiver

Receipt confirms custody transfer, not ownership verification or final release.

3. Which statement exceeds the evidence?

B. It must belong to the last person who stayed in the room.

Room location and checkout timing do not establish the item's owner.

4. What should happen to a later claim?

B. Follow the actual ownership-verification and release process

A claim needs the designated process rather than an unsupported assumption or disclosure.

05 Conversation answers

Handling found items and privacy questions

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 46-47

1. lost-property receiver. Turn 2. Lost-property receiver identifies Dev's designated role in accepting the item through the site process, not ownership of it.

2. visible description. Turn 4. Visible description is limited to the closed black case and does not claim knowledge of its contents.

3. find location. Turn 6. Find location records room 214 and the position beneath the chair, helping identify the discovery accurately.

4. ownership. Turn 8. Ownership remains unverified; discovery in a room after checkout does not establish who owns the item.

5. receipt confirmation. Turn 10. Receipt confirmation establishes that Dev actually received the item, not merely that a transfer was proposed.

6. custody record. Turn 12. Custody record tracks who holds the item; a staff transfer does not mean it has been returned to a verified owner.

7. ownership claim. Turn 14. Ownership claim is a person's assertion, which must be verified through the actual process rather than accepted from a room number alone.

8. privacy boundary. Turn 16. Privacy boundary limits unnecessary or unauthorized disclosure of guest information during a found-property query.

9. property record. Turn 18. Property record captures the established item details and handling facts without inventing contents, ownership, or final release.

10. release. Turn 20. Release is the separate authorized return to an entitled recipient; the completed staff receipt does not establish it.

F Transfer conversation

Page 48

1. pouch

Attendant: "The item is a closed navy pouch."

Pouch is the visible container supplied in the new scenario.

2. desk

Receiver: "The find location is the desk."

The desk is the specific location where the pouch was found.

3. 318

Attendant: "The room number is 318."

Room 318 is the recorded room, not an ownership verification.

4. unknown

Receiver: "The owner remains unknown."

Confirmed staff receipt does not establish who owns the item.

05

06 Briefing and language checks

Counting linen and replenishing supplies

A Briefing checks / page 49

1. What is the bath-towel shortfall?

A. Three

The target of twelve minus the counted nine leaves three bath towels.

2. What is the hand-towel status?

D. Eight counted against a target of eight

The hand-towel count already matches its specified target.

3. What is known about the delivery?

B. It is expected but not confirmed

Neither arrival nor contents are confirmed, so expected stock cannot close the shortfall.

D Language checks / page 54

1. Which report is best?

A. Nine of twelve bath towels; eight of eight hand towels; three bath towels short.

The report preserves each item count, target, and exact numerical shortage.

2. Why not count the expected delivery?

C. Its arrival and contents are unconfirmed.

Anticipation does not establish that the needed items are present and checked.

3. Which request matches the shortfall?

C. Three additional bath towels

Three bath towels fill the difference between the target and current count.

4. What does the cart target establish?

D. A required stock mix, not the number of occupied rooms

The target specifies cart quantities and does not supply occupancy or substitution authority.

06 Conversation answers

Counting linen and replenishing supplies

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 55-56

- 1. physical count.** Turn 2. Physical count is the quantity actually observed on the cart, which must remain separate from expected delivery stock.
- 2. shortfall.** Turn 4. Shortfall is the difference between the bath-towel target of twelve and the actual count of nine.
- 3. linen cart.** Turn 6. Linen cart locates this count on the third floor; the report does not establish inventory for the entire building.
- 4. expected delivery.** Turn 8. Expected delivery describes anticipated supply, not confirmed arrival, checked contents, or completed replenishment.
- 5. Stock on hand.** Turn 10. Stock on hand is the actual supply present now; future or unconfirmed items must not be included.
- 6. replenishment request.** Turn 12. Replenishment request specifies three additional bath towels and preserves the individual-item unit needed to fill the gap.
- 7. substitution.** Turn 14. Substitution would replace one item type with another; the count supplies no approval to use hand towels for the bath-towel shortage.
- 8. delivery contents.** Turn 16. Delivery contents identify the actual items and quantities supplied; an arrival alone does not prove the required bath towels are included.
- 9. stock update.** Turn 18. Stock update should reflect a verified change in actual quantities, not a prediction about an unconfirmed delivery.
- 10. stock target.** Turn 20. Stock target specifies the required cart mix; it is not evidence about occupied rooms or completed replenishment.

F Transfer conversation

Page 57

1. ten

Attendant: "The bath-towel target is ten."

Ten is the required bath-towel stock for this cart.

2. seven

Lead: "The counted bath towels total seven."

Seven is the physical bath-towel count supplied in the scenario.

3. three

Attendant: "We need three additional bath towels."

Ten required minus seven present leaves three bath towels missing.

4. six

Lead: "The hand-towel count is six."

Six hand towels are present and match their separate target.

07 Briefing and language checks

Responding to a quality concern

A Briefing checks / page 58

1. Which surface is reported?

C. Interior glass panel beside office 8

The brief identifies the interior panel and its location beside office 8.

2. What is known about the cause?

D. It is unknown

The report identifies a result but does not establish its cause.

3. What can Dana do now?

D. Point out the panel

Dana is available to identify the relevant panel, while checking and rework remain pending.

D Language checks / page 63

1. Which opening is most useful?

B. Thank you for pointing it out; could you show me the interior panel beside office 8?

The response acknowledges the concern and seeks an exact location without a guessed cause.

2. What does cleaned earlier establish?

B. A past cleaning activity, not verified current quality

The earlier activity does not by itself settle the present reported result.

3. Which next step fits the brief?

B. Ask Rosa to arrange a check and appropriate rework

Rosa is the named lead who can arrange the required check and response.

4. Which statement falsely closes the issue?

C. The panel is now verified clear because the client reported it.

A report supplies a concern, not evidence of completed correction or verification.

07 Conversation answers

Responding to a quality concern

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 64-65

1. quality concern. Turn 2. Quality concern acknowledges the reported unsatisfactory result without denying it because cleaning was performed earlier.

2. interior glass. Turn 4. Interior glass distinguishes the reported panel from an exterior window, helping the team inspect the correct surface.

3. reported result. Turn 6. Reported result attributes the streaks to the client's observation while the cleaner has not yet completed a direct check.

4. verification check. Turn 8. Verification check would establish the actual result against requirements; a past cleaning activity does not replace it.

5. inspection. Turn 10. Inspection is the next examination needed to establish the condition and appropriate response, not a completed correction.

6. streaks. Turn 12. Streaks is the actual reported description; changing it to scratches would add an unsupported claim of damage.

7. update commitment. Turn 14. Update commitment promises communication of checked progress rather than an unsupported completion time or guaranteed finish.

8. Rework. Turn 16. Rework is corrective work that may be arranged after the check; it has not already been completed in this exchange.

9. follow-up arrangement. Turn 18. Follow-up arrangement connects the correct panel and concern with Rosa's check, while preserving the client's availability to identify it.

10. resolution. Turn 20. Resolution requires an established outcome addressing the concern; receiving the complaint and arranging a check do not themselves resolve it.

F Transfer conversation

Page 66

1. smears

Cleaner: "The reported marks are smears."

Smears is the client's description and should not become an invented diagnosis.

2. 12

Client: "The panel is beside office 12."

Office 12 is the specific location supplied for the concern.

3. Ben

Cleaner: "The lead for the check is Ben."

Ben is the named person who can arrange the follow-up.

4. unknown

Cleaner: "The cause remains unknown."

The report establishes a concern but not its technical cause.

08 Briefing and language checks

Giving a clear end-of-shift handover

A Briefing checks / page 67

1. Which rooms have been cleaned?

A. 301 and 302

The brief establishes cleaning of 301 and 302, but not of inaccessible 303.

2. What remains for 302?

D. Rosa's inspection

Room 302 is cleaned and specifically awaits the supervisor's inspection.

3. What is the status of 303?

A. Inaccessible and not cleaned; access follow-up can pass to Arun

Inaccessibility prevented cleaning, and the handover assigns follow-up rather than changing that fact.

D Language checks / page 72

1. Which summary is accurate?

B. 301 cleaned; 302 cleaned, inspection pending; 303 inaccessible and not cleaned.

The summary preserves the distinct completed and unfinished stages for each room.

2. What does Arun accept?

C. Access follow-up for 303

Arun accepts responsibility for checking access, not completed cleaning or room-release authority.

3. What can be said about 301's inspection?

A. No result is supplied in this handover.

The brief supplies cleaned status only and does not establish any inspection outcome.

4. When should a status change?

D. After the relevant actual work or authorized decision

Status records should follow real events and permissions rather than expectations or shift changes.

08 Conversation answers

Giving a clear end-of-shift handover

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 73-74

1. handover log. Turn 2. Handover log records the separate room states and next tasks, rather than treating the end of a shift as completion.

2. cleaned. Turn 4. Cleaned is the established stage for room 301; no inspection result or release decision should be added.

3. awaiting inspection. Turn 6. Awaiting inspection preserves the pending check after cleaning, distinguishing room 302 from an inspected or released room.

4. inspection owner. Turn 8. Inspection owner identifies Rosa's responsibility for room 302; receiving a handover does not automatically transfer that task.

5. access follow-up. Turn 10. Access follow-up is the task Arun accepts for room 303; it is not authorization for immediate entry or proof of cleaning.

6. not cleaned. Turn 12. Not cleaned is room 303's actual cleaning state; accepting an access task does not change it.

7. Room release. Turn 14. Room release is a separate authorized decision, which cannot be inferred from cleaning, task acceptance, or this handover alone.

8. task acceptance. Turn 16. Task acceptance confirms Arun's responsibility for the access follow-up while leaving the inspection with Rosa and both tasks unfinished.

9. separate status. Turn 18. Separate status maintains a distinct evidence-based entry for each room instead of copying another room's stage or assuming all are alike.

10. status transition. Turn 20. Status transition should follow the actual task result or authorized decision, not the arrival of a new shift or a repeated promise.

F Transfer conversation

Page 75

1. 411

Outgoing: "The room awaiting inspection is 411."

Room 411 is cleaned but still requires its identified inspection.

2. Ben

Incoming: "The inspection owner is Ben."

Ben is named as responsible for the pending room inspection.

3. 412

Outgoing: "The inaccessible, uncleaned room is 412."

Room 412 has not been cleaned because access was unavailable.

4. Jo

Incoming: "The access follow-up has been accepted by Jo."

Jo accepts the follow-up, which does not establish completed access or cleaning.

Find the move you need

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

01 Confirming the assignment and its limits

Acknowledge the timing: I understand the meeting starts at three.

Name the exclusion: High windows are not in my current assignment.

Avoid a blanket promise: I cannot confirm all of that from this assignment.

Full phrase set: pages 7-8 | Dialogue: pages 10-11

02 Respecting access and occupied spaces

Acknowledge the refusal: Certainly; I will not start service now.

Avoid an exact promise: I cannot promise exactly eleven.

Confirm the return: I have recorded the eleven-fifteen-to-eleven-thirty window.

Full phrase set: pages 16-17 | Dialogue: pages 19-20

03 Clarifying product and task information

State the problem: I cannot read this bottle label.

Explain the ambiguity: Two products use similar bottles here.

Ask for the document: Which safety data sheet belongs to this product?

Full phrase set: pages 25-26 | Dialogue: pages 28-29

04 Reporting faults and unsafe access

Lead with location: Water is visible outside washroom B.

Avoid a diagnosis: I am not confirming a plumbing fault.

Correct direction: East stair door, not west.

Full phrase set: pages 34-35 | Dialogue: pages 37-38

Keep the conversation productive

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

05 Handling found items and privacy questions

Open the report: I found a closed black glasses case.

State timing: I found it after checkout.

Request transfer: I need to hand this over through the site procedure.

Full phrase set: pages 43-44 | Dialogue: pages 46-47

06 Counting linen and replenishing supplies

Identify the cart: This is the third-floor linen cart.

Calculate the gap: We are three bath towels short.

Preserve uncertainty: The laundry delivery is expected but not confirmed.

Full phrase set: pages 52-53 | Dialogue: pages 55-56

07 Responding to a quality concern

Acknowledge the concern: Thank you for pointing out the streaks.

Ask for a precise indication: Could you point out the affected area?

Explain the next stage: The check will establish what appropriate rework is needed.

Full phrase set: pages 61-62 | Dialogue: pages 64-65

08 Giving a clear end-of-shift handover

Start the room list: I have separate updates for 301, 302, and 303.

State the second stage: Room 302 is cleaned and awaiting inspection.

Assign follow-up: Can you take the access follow-up for 303?

Full phrase set: pages 70-71 | Dialogue: pages 73-74

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

access follow-up	accept an access follow-up	68
access permission	confirm access permission	14
access record	update the access record	15
access restriction	preserve an access restriction	69
additional work	request additional work	5
affected area	identify the affected area	33
appointment time	confirm the appointment time	14
approved change	record an approved change	6
assignment	confirm the assignment	5
authorization	obtain authorization	5
availability	clarify availability	15
awaiting inspection	retain awaiting-inspection status	68
bath mat	identify the bath mat	50
bath towel	replenish bath towels	50
capacity	check team capacity	6
carryover work	track carryover work	69
cause analysis	separate cause analysis from acknowledgement	60
checkout	distinguish checkout from ownership	41
claimant	refer a claimant for verification	41
clarification request	raise a clarification request	6
cleaned	mark the room cleaned	68
cleaner	identify the cleaner	24
clearance	await clearance	33
client contact	speak with the client contact	5

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

client feedback	receive client feedback	60
closed item	preserve the closed item	41
completion claim	avoid an unsupported completion claim	60
completion estimate	obtain a completion estimate	6
completion evidence	require completion evidence	69
concentrate	identify a concentrate	24
confirmation	obtain confirmation	15
confirmed receipt	record confirmed receipt	51
container	identify the container	23
contents	avoid guessing the contents	41
corridor	locate the corridor	32
count discrepancy	report a count discrepancy	51
custody	confirm custody	42
custody record	maintain the custody record	42
deadline	clarify the deadline	6
declined service	record declined service	14
delivery contents	verify delivery contents	51
detergent	identify the detergent	24
dilution	verify dilution instructions	24
direct observation	distinguish direct observation	60
disclosure	avoid unauthorized disclosure	42
disinfectant	identify the disinfectant	24
do-not-disturb notice	respect a do-not-disturb notice	14
doorstep delivery	offer doorstep delivery	14

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

duvet cover count duvet covers	50
edge identify the affected edge	59
entry procedure follow the entry procedure	14
exact location give the exact location	32
exact-time promise avoid an unsupported exact-time promise	15
exception report submit an exception report	69
exclusion explain an exclusion	6
expected delivery distinguish an expected delivery	51
exposure report an exposure	24
factual correction make a factual correction	42
fault diagnosis avoid an unsupported fault diagnosis	33
find location record the find location	41
finish assess the finish	59
fitted sheet check fitted-sheet stock	50
flat sheet identify a flat sheet	50
floor allocation check the floor allocation	50
floor area identify the floor area	5
follow-up arrangement confirm a follow-up arrangement	60
follow-up owner name the follow-up owner	33
follow-up priority clarify follow-up priority	69
found property report found property	41
frame distinguish the frame from glass	59
fresh towels offer fresh towels	14
glass panel locate the glass panel	59

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

glasses case describe the glasses case	41
guest preference record the guest preference	15
hand towel count hand towels	50
handover log maintain the handover log	68
hazard report submit a hazard report	33
hazard statement read the hazard statement	23
haze describe a haze	59
high window clarify high-window work	5
identified replacement request an identified replacement	24
inaccessible report an inaccessible room	68
incoming shift brief the incoming shift	68
inspection arrange an inspection	60
inspection owner name the inspection owner	68
inspection result record the inspection result	69
interior glass identify interior glass	59
interruption avoid an unnecessary interruption	15
item description record the item description	42
item type specify the item type	51
landmark name a clear landmark	32
laundry delivery check the laundry delivery	51
leak verify a suspected leak	32
linen count the linen	50
linen cart replenish the linen cart	50
lost-property receiver contact the lost-property receiver	41

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

maintenance referral arrange a maintenance referral	33
manufacturer instructions follow manufacturer instructions	23
meeting setup separate cleaning from meeting setup	6
not cleaned preserve not-cleaned status	68
observed condition report the observed condition	32
occupied room respect an occupied room	14
outgoing shift brief the outgoing shift	68
outstanding task identify an outstanding task	69
owner verify the owner	41
ownership claim verify an ownership claim	41
par level compare with par level	50
partition identify the partition	59
personal equipment exclude personal equipment	5
physical count complete a physical count	51
pictogram recognize the pictogram	23
pillowcase replenish pillowcases	50
PPE verify required PPE	24
precautionary statement understand the precautionary statement	23
priority confirm the priority	6
privacy respect guest privacy	14
privacy boundary respect the privacy boundary	42
product identifier verify the product identifier	23
product information request product information	23
property record create a property record	41

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

quality concern acknowledge a quality concern	59
read-back give a scope read-back	6
readiness verify readiness	33
ready-to-use confirm ready-to-use status	24
receipt confirmation obtain receipt confirmation	42
reference number record the reference number	42
release authorize release	42
release authority confirm release authority	69
reopening confirm reopening	33
replenishment request submit a replenishment request	51
report acknowledgement obtain report acknowledgement	33
reported result acknowledge the reported result	60
residue identify residue	59
resolution confirm resolution	60
return window offer a return window	14
rework arrange appropriate rework	60
room attendant speak with the room attendant	14
room identifier repeat the room identifier	69
room release verify room release	68
room status report room status	68
room-status board update the room-status board	68
safety data sheet consult the safety data sheet	23
sanitizer distinguish a sanitizer	24
scheduled return record a scheduled return	15

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

scope of work clarify the scope of work	5
scratch distinguish a scratch from residue	59
SDS obtain the relevant SDS	23
secondary container check a secondary container	23
separate status preserve separate statuses	69
service deferral arrange a service deferral	15
service option explain a service option	14
service request record a service request	15
service specification follow the service specification	6
service standard check the service standard	60
shortfall calculate the shortfall	51
signal word identify the signal word	23
site controls follow site controls	33
site procedure follow the site procedure	42
site supervisor consult the site supervisor	5
slip hazard report a slip hazard	32
smear describe a smear	59
source investigate the source	32
stair door identify the stair door	32
stair landing describe the stair landing	32
status transition verify a status transition	69
status update provide a status update	33
stock on hand report stock on hand	51
stock target confirm the stock target	50

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

stock update provide a stock update	51
streak report streaks on glass	59
substitution avoid an unapproved substitution	51
surface access confirm surface access	6
surface compatibility verify surface compatibility	24
table surface clean the table surfaces	5
task acceptance confirm task acceptance	69
task boundary state the task boundary	6
task list review the task list	5
threshold identify the threshold	32
time range repeat the time range	15
transfer document the transfer	42
trip hazard distinguish a trip hazard	33
unoccupied verify unoccupied status	15
unreadable label report an unreadable label	23
update commitment make an update commitment	60
ventilation check ventilation requirements	24
verification check complete a verification check	60
verified recipient identify the verified recipient	42
visible description give a visible description	41
visible water report visible water	32
visit plan confirm the visit plan	15
washroom identify the washroom	32
work order check the work order	5

Original cases. Clear boundaries.

These are original fictional teaching conversations, not transcripts of real workers. Names, figures, organizations, and incidents are invented. Sources support terminology and communication aims, not the fictional results or an endorsement of this book.

[1] US Bureau of Labor Statistics. Janitors and Building Cleaners.

[Open the original source](#)

Occupational context for task assignments, surface cleaning, supplies, and reporting maintenance needs. Individual duties depend on the actual role and site. Checked 1 October 2026.

[2] US Bureau of Labor Statistics. Maids and Housekeeping Cleaners.

[Open the original source](#)

Occupational context for guest-room cleaning and linen replenishment. No guest-access or property-release rule is inferred from this profile. Checked 1 October 2026.

[3] Occupational Safety and Health Administration. Hazard Communication.

[Open the original source](#)

Background for product identification, labels, safety data sheets, and understandable hazard information. The book supplies no chemical-use instructions. Checked 1 October 2026.

[4] Centers for Disease Control and Prevention. When and How to Clean and Disinfect a Facility.

[Open the original source](#)

Terminology distinguishing cleaning and disinfection in community facilities. This guidance is not a substitute for healthcare or other specialized-site requirements. Checked 1 October 2026.

Phil Stilwell

© 2026 Phil Stilwell. All rights reserved.

No part of this publication may be reproduced, stored in a retrieval system, or transmitted in any form or by any means without prior written permission from the author, except as permitted by law.

All sites, rooms, quantities, guests, and incidents are fictional. This book teaches workplace English, not chemical handling, equipment operation, hazard control, legal advice, or specialist infection prevention. Follow actual training, product labels and safety data sheets, site access rules, privacy and found-property procedures, and emergency arrangements. No example authorizes unsafe access, use of an unidentified product, or release of an unchecked area.

English Ladder | English for Work | 2026 edition. The B2-C1 range is an editorial study recommendation, not a proficiency certification.

[Open the matching English Ladder course](#)